# FROM TREATMENT TO SCREEN: THE MAKING OF THE VOICE OF PENNY AS A TOOL FOR AUTISM AWARENESS AND SOCIAL INCLUSION SHORT FILM

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# FROM TREATMENT TO SCREEN: THE MAKING OF THE VOICE OF PENNY AS A TOOL FOR AUTISM AWARENESS AND SOCIAL INCLUSION

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**CREATIVE MEDIA PROJECT SUBMITTED IN PARTIAL FULFILMENT OF THE REQUIREMENTS FOR THE DEGREE OF MASTER OF MEDIA STUDEIS**

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Field of Study: Creative Media Project

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## ABSTRACT

This report examines the development of *The Voice of Penny*, a short film about autism, artistic expression, and social inclusion through visual storytelling.

## ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

This project would not have been completed without the support of many people.

I would like to thank my supervisor, Dr. Rosya Izyanie Shamshudeen, for her guidance and feedback throughout this project. Her support helped me shape and improve creative and academic direction of this project.

I am also grateful to Infinite Minds Academy (IMA) for giving us the opportunity to work with them. Special thanks to Aaron Yap for his support, patience, and cooperation during the planning and filming stages. I would also like to thank the staff and students of IMA for welcoming our team and assisting us during production.

My appreciation also goes to my teammates, Ren Yuhang and Arun Kumar A/L Rajendran. We faced many challenges throughout this project, but their commitment and teamwork helped us complete the film.

I would also like to express my gratitude to my Master's friends, those that I'm close with or not. Their participation and cooperation in our project, in a form of cheering and clapping, has a significant mark in my memory.

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**TABLE OF CONTENTS**

ORIGINAL LITERARY WORK DECLARATION ..... iii
Abstract ..... iv
Acknowledgements ..... v
Table of Contents ..... vi
CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION ..... 1
1.1 Project Background and Problem Statement ..... 1
1.2 Creative Inspiration ..... 1
1.3 Project Objectives ..... 2
1.4 Theoretical Framework ..... 2
1.5 Scope and Limitations ..... 4
CHAPTER 2: PRE-PRODUCTION ..... 5
2.1 Client Collaboration and Project Development ..... 5
Figure 2.1 The logo of Infinite Minds Academy ..... 5
Figure 2.2 First visit to IMA on 2nd April ..... 6
Figure 2.3 A group photo of the team and Aaron Yap ..... 7
2.2 Research and Script Development ..... 7
Figure 2.4 Abhineya holding The Malaysian Book of Records with her family ..... 8
2.3 Production Planning and Documentation ..... 9
2.3.1 Script ..... 9
2.3.2 Shooting Script ..... 10
2.3.3 Shot List ..... 10
2.4 Storyboard and Visual Planning ..... 10
2.5 Casting, Location Scouting, and Resource Preparation ..... 11
2.5.1 Casting ..... 11
Figure 2.5 Nur Farhani Samantha Woodford Binti Mohd Tajudin (Penny) 12
Figure 2.6 Yang Yunni (Penny's Mother) ..... 13

Figure 2.7 Aaron Yap (Male Trainer) ..... 13
Figure 2.8 Hu Huiwen (Female Trainer) ..... 13
2.5.2 Location Scouting ..... 14
Figure 2.9 The entrance of IMA ..... 15
Figure 2.10 IMA Classroom ..... 15
Figure 2.11 IMA Office ..... 15
Figure 2.12 Apartment overview ..... 16
Figure 2.13 Auditorium overview ..... 17
2.5.3 Resource Preparation and Budgeting ..... 17
Figure 2.14 Sony A6400 ..... 18
Figure 2.15 Microphones, clapper board, and reflector ..... 18
Figure 2.16 Camera tripod ..... 19
Figure 2.17 Lighting ..... 19
Figure 2.18 Lion plush ..... 20
Figure 2.19 Sketch book and drawings ..... 20
2.6 Pre-production Challenges and Solutions ..... 21
CHAPTER 3: PRODUCTION ..... 23
3.1 Production Approach and Crew Responsibilities ..... 23
3.2 Directing Performance and Working with Actors ..... 25
3.3 Cinematography and Visual Execution ..... 27
Figure 3.1 BTS photo of me handholding a camera shooting Penny sitting alone ..... 28
3.4 Production Challenges and Adaptation ..... 29
3.5 Reflection on Production Decisions ..... 30
CHAPTER 4: POST-PRODUCTION ..... 32
4.1 Editing and Narrative Assembly ..... 32
Figure 4.1 Editing process on Adobe Premiere Pro ..... 32
4.2 Sound Design and Audio ..... 34
Figure 4.2 Sound designing process ..... 36
4.3 Music Composing and Scoring ..... 36

Figure 4.3 Music composition on FL Studio ..... 37
4.4 Color Grading and Visual Tone ..... 38
Figure 4.4 Primary color grading interface ..... 38
Figure 4.5 Secondary color grading interface ..... 39
4.5 Promotional Materials and Poster Design ..... 41
Figure 4.6 Poster for the Momentus 2026 exhibition ..... 41
Figure 4.7 Poster for the short film: The Voice of Penny ..... 42
4.6 Feedback, Revisions, and Final Delivery ..... 42
Figure 4.8 Aaron Yap's reaction after watching our short film ..... 43
CHAPTER 5: CONCLUSION ..... 45
5.1 Evaluation of Project Objectives ..... 45
5.2 Evaluation of Creative Outcomes ..... 46
5.3 Limitations and Recommendations for Future Improvement ..... 47
5.4 Personal and Professional Development ..... 48
5.5 Conclusion ..... 50
REFERENCES ..... 51
APPENDICES ..... 52
Appendix A: Letter of Consent ..... 52
Appendix B: Confirmation Letter of Collaboration ..... 53
Appendix C: Pre-production Documents ..... 54
(a) Script ..... 54
(b) Treatment ..... 61
(c) Storyboard ..... 71
(d) Shooting Script ..... 108
(e) Shot List ..... 113
(f) Budget Management ..... 117
Appendix D: Production Documents ..... 118
(g) Call Sheet ..... 118
(h) Permission Letter: Infinite Minds Academy ..... 119

(i) Permission Letter: Trion Apartment ..... 121
(j) Permission Letter: UM Auditorium ..... 123

# CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION

## 1.1 Project Background and Problem Statement

Movies are often utilized to tell tales and convey diverse perspectives. At the same time, it can shape the way audiences understand specific groups of individuals. However, not all communities are well-represented in the media, and some are shown through stereotypes.

This is visible in the representation of autistic people, especially non-verbal people. Previous studies have shown that autistic characters are often reduced to a limited range of stereotypes, particularly the socially isolated individual or the exceptionally gifted savant (Draaisma, 2009, pp. 1477–1478; Kapp et al., 2013, p. 62). Such representations may increase visibility but often fail to reflect the diversity of autistic experiences. As Draaisma (2009) pointed out, repeated media description helps to form the stereotype of autism, which can affect the public's understanding more than clinical knowledge (p. 1477). This highlights the need for a more detailed description of individuals with autism in screen media.

## 1.2 Creative Inspiration

My experience working on this project and my personal interests made me think of *The Voice of Penny*. When I first read the important topic of "Cinema of Voices," I began to think about those who were not often heard. Finally, this prompted me to study the story of people with special needs.

After searching on the Internet and Google Maps, I found Infinite Minds Academy (IMA). When I visited the college, I saw students learning digital art, animation, and other creative abilities. What moved me was not their situation, but their intelligence and passion. I quickly noticed that many of them had talents and qualities that were rarely talked about in the mainstream media.

The story of Abhineya, an autistic girl who became famous at the national level for solving puzzles, was another source of inspiration (Shangkari, 2026). Her narrative reminded me that people are assessed by their struggles before their strengths are acknowledged. I kept that notion in mind as I made the picture and eventually, it was that idea that shaped the character of Penny. I intended to give the viewers Penny mostly through images and feelings as director, cinematographer and editor. With that in mind, I relied quite a lot on performance, cinematography, sound design, editing and symbolism instead of extensive dialogue scenes.

## 1.3 Project Objectives

This project was established with three primary aims.

**1.3.1.** To create a 3-5 minute short film that compellingly and respectfully conveys the experiences of a nonverbal autistic teen.

**1.3.2.** To explore the theme of *Cinema of Voices* by placing Penny's perspective at the center of the story.

**1.3.3.** To encourage greater awareness and social inclusion of neurodiversity.

Besides these objectives, I also hoped the film would encourage viewers to think about communication differently. Not all communication is done by spoken words and voices. Sometimes people express themselves through art, actions, or other forms of creativity.

## 1.4 Theoretical Framework

The Voice of Penny is a creative creation, although various ideas have impacted the development of the film.

One is the concept of neurodiversity. Singer (1998) introduced neurodiversity as an alternative framework for understanding neural differences, and believed

that autism and other conditions should not be viewed only through the medical defect model (pp. 9-11). Based on this view, Armstrong (2010) described neural diversity as a form of human variation equivalent to racial, cultural, or personality differences (pp. 6-8). The framework encourages people to recognize their strengths, abilities, and other ways to experience the world, rather than focusing on damage. This perspective provides clues for the development of Penny's creation. Penny's character is constructed around artistic expression and personal growth rather than pathology. Walker (2014) pointed out that this view will affect the diversity of education, society, and media representatives. This is my view of Penny's character. I wanted to show the audience her interests, skills, and personal growth, not just dwell on the challenges of autism.

Another concept that affects the project is the artistic expression of communication. Researchers believe that creative activities can enable people to exchange ideas and emotions that are difficult to express orally (Spring, 2008, P. 244; Malchiodi, 2015, pp. 3-5). Not every autistic person communicates in the same way. However, creative practice can provide another form of expression for some people and may support self-understanding, self-confidence, and social interaction (Malchiodi, 2015, pp. 6-8). This idea becomes an important part of the story. In this film, painting is not just Penny's hobby. This became one of her main ways to express herself. This method also reflects the view of neural diversity, which encourages the recognition of different forms of communication, rather than evaluating individuals only through traditional language ability (Armstrong, 2010, pp. 6-8; Kapp et al., 2013, pp. 60-63).

The important theme of "Cinema of Voices" has also influenced my early creative decisions. It encourages me to think about those voices that are often ignored. It also affects how I use framings, sound design, editing, and the visual symbols throughout our short film.

These concepts do not determine every creative decision. However, they provide a useful direction in the project development process.

## 1.5 Scope and Limitations

This report covers the development of *The Voice of Penny* from pre-production to production to post-production. It discusses key stages of the project, including client collaboration, script and screenplay development, directing, cinematography, and editing.

As the director, photographer, and editor of the project, I am mainly concerned with the idea and technical decision of shaping the final film. We developed and informed this project by doing research and observation at the IMA. However, we had no intentions to represent every autistic experience. We created Penny as a fictional character through research, observation, and creative interpretation.

The report also has several limitations. It does not include a formal audience reception study or large-scale audience analysis. Instead, the discussion focuses on the production process itself. The emphasis is on the decisions made during the project, the challenges encountered, and the outcomes of the final production.

# CHAPTER 2: PRE-PRODUCTION

Pre-production paves the road before actual filming begins. This stage involved finding a suitable client, developing the story, preparing production documents, and organizing the resources needed for the shoot. Many of the decisions made during this period later affected both the production and post-production processes. Looking back, some plans worked as expected while others changed along the way. This chapter discusses how *The Voice of Penny* developed from an initial idea into a project that was ready for filming.

## 2.1 Client Collaboration and Project Development

The search for a client began shortly after the MOMENTUS 2026 theme was announced. Since the theme focused on voices, I was interested in exploring stories or voices that are not often represented in mainstream media. This led me to Infinite Minds Academy (IMA), an organization that supports neurodivergent youth through creative and technology-based learning.




*Figure 2.1 The logo of Infinite Minds Academy*

After reading about the academy and its programs, I became interested in the work they were doing, such as the paintings, animated videos and 3D modeling products. What stood out to me was their focus on helping students develop skills and confidence rather than defining them by their challenges. This aligned

closely with the type of story I wanted to tell – the story of an artist rather than a victim.

From the initial contact, Aaron Yap became the main contact person for our entire project. Through standardized meetings, discussions, and on-site visits, we gradually had a clearer understanding of the college and the operation mode of this cooperation. We prepared an official letter of intent to formalize the cooperation and then received an email confirming the cooperation (see Appendices A and B).



*Figure 2.2 First visit to IMA on 2nd April*

There were some misunderstandings in the early stages of animation, budgeting, and project expectations, which occasionally cause confusion in terms of responsibilities and creative direction. For instance, the initial script contains characters that are more achievable through animations, which requires manpower their side and additional budget. However, when we confirmed that we could not use animations in our project, we had to inform the team to cancel it. Although these problems were frustrating at the time, as we made our goals and expectations clearer, we could finally solve these problems. Both parties have defined their expectations and reached an agreement on the scope of the project.

This reminds me that communication is as important as creative planning, especially when cooperating with customers outside the media industry.

Aaron's involvement in this project went beyond collaborative communication. He later played the role of a male coach and helped coordinate the students during the shooting process. His support made several classroom scenes easier to organize and added a sense of reality; otherwise, it would be difficult for us to achieve.




*Figure 2.3 A group photo of the team and Aaron Yap*

## 2.2 Research and Script Development

The story was not solid at the beginning of the project. It was gradually developed through research, observation, discussion with our client, and several rounds of script revision.

One of the influences is the story of Abhineya, a 7-year-old autistic girl. After completing a 643-piece jigsaw puzzle in less than an hour, she entered the

Malaysian record book (Shangkari, 2026). What interested me was not only the achievement itself, but also how easily these abilities could be ignored. This reinforced my interest in telling a story that focused on potential rather than limitation.




*Figure 2.4 Abhineya holding The Malaysian Book of Records with her family*

The neurodiversity perspective argues that neurological differences should not automatically be viewed as deficits that require correction (Singer, 1998; Armstrong, 2010, pp. 6-7). While I understood that autism can involve real challenges, I did not want Penny to be defined only by those challenges. This decision aligns with neurodiversity scholarship, which argues that autistic individuals should be understood through both strengths and challenges rather than deficit-based narratives alone (Kapp et al., 2013, pp. 60–63). By emphasizing Penny's artistic abilities, our short film project attempts to move beyond conventional media stereotypes and present a more balanced representation of autism.

Visits to Infinite Minds Academy contributed just as much as academic research. On site, we were able to stay at the back of the classroom and listen to the classes while the teachers, or so-called *trainers*, were using advanced technology, such as drawing tablets and 3D modeling applications like Render to lecture. Observing students and talking to the academy representatives provided insights that serve as unique primary data apart from journal articles. These experiences built the foundation of the film and the interaction of several characters.

## 2.3 Production Planning and Documentation

To maintain the order of production, we prepared documents including scripts, treatments, shooting scripts, shot lists, call lists, location plans, and equipment checklists (see Appendix C).

### 2.3.1 Script

Arun and I have been the main script writers for this project. Initially, we built our story based on a different concept — a concept of a magical pen or a superpower.

Since IMA aims at teaching creative skills to autistic youth, I proposed a story in which the protagonist has the ability to draw something and turn it into a real form. Our client agreed to my proposal, yet it got stuck as we moved forward, as it might require animations and complicated visual effects.

Later, we developed a story that had two protagonists—Mr. Lion and Penny. It portrayed Penny, a nonverbal autistic teen, who is quiet yet has a good talent at drawing. She is then recommended to change school, and a series of problems arise. Penny gets scared, so she draws Mr. Lion, hoping that this figure could help her get through, and that's where the magic happens: Mr. Lion comes alive.

Our team was satisfied with this story, yet it contains numerous elements that exceeded what a 5-minute short film can include.

Thus, after 3 rounds of revision and refinement, we developed a simpler story. It is about an autistic teen, Penny's, drawing talent being found by the trainer and being encouraged to participate in a national drawing competition. Then she finally wins the award and is seen by the others. It conveys a simple message—any person, no matter how they communicate, deserves to be heard and seen.

We then wrote a treatment (see Appendix C, b) based on this script and proposed to our supervisor, Dr. Rosya, and received her feedback.

### 2.3.2 Shooting Script

As Arun and I developed and refined our final script, I translated the script into a shooting script. Scene by scene, I converted descriptions, dialogue, and actions into tables classified by shots, types of shot, description, and audio. It provides simple descriptions of how we illustrate the script on screen.

### 2.3.3 Shot List

The shot list is one of the most important ones, as it provides a clear overview of each planned shooting and helps us to understand the shooting requirements of each scene. Ren was responsible for listing and dividing all shots into different categories and grouping them. For example, we grouped shots by location or scene so that we would not miss any shots when shooting in a scene. In this way, we would be aware of the shots we need to take in one place and another.

## 2.4 Storyboard and Visual Planning

After the script, the shooting script, and the shot list reach a feasible version, the next step is to translate the written story into a visual scene, that is, storyboarding and visual planning. The storyboards helped us visualize how these scenarios are displayed and framed on the screen.

We developed the storyboard based on Penny's emotional journey (see Appendix C). Since the film pays close attention to her personal experience and feelings, visual elements have become an important part of the storytelling. At this stage, we considered different shooting angles, shooting options, and lighting concepts to support the narrative. For example, shot types such as close-up shots and medium close-up shots were useful to describe Penny's experience and reaction to the environment. At the same time, the use of the restricted framework is to encourage the audience to experience discomfort and feel pressure related to Penny's perspective. By combining visual design with character experience, this film attempts to cultivate empathy rather than observing from a distance.

After the second visit on 4th May, 2026, we made some adjustments to our storyboards and visual planning. As we walked around in the IMA, we found that some scenes in our storyboard are not practical and logical. For example, casual communications could happen anywhere in the academy, yet formal communications between parents and the trainers are always conducted in an office. Therefore, we shifted the hallway scene to the office scene for two reasons: one is to make it as realistic as possible, and one is to minimize the background and ambient noise, especially when there is dialogue.

## 2.5 Casting, Location Scouting, and Resource Preparation

### 2.5.1 Casting

Casting and positioning preparation are important parts of the pre-production process. Since Penny's voice focuses on a non-verbal autistic teenager, it's necessary to find a suitable performer to ensure that the story can be presented in a credible and respectful way.

For the choice of actors, we held a self-taped audition, and the applicants recorded their own performance based on a script of selection and submitted the

recording to us for our evaluations. In this way, there is no necessity for the actors to do auditions in person. They can record whenever it’s convenient for them at home, and we can evaluate their performance whenever it’s convenient for us.

Eventually, we selected Nur Farhani Samantha Woodford Binti Mohd Tajudin as our protagonist Penny; Yang Yunni played Penny's mother, Aaron Yap acted as the male trainer, and Hu Huiwen took on the role of the female trainer. We made the selection decisions based on their experience and compatibility with the story. For example, Aaron Yap is an IMA trainer himself, so he could draw on his own experience for the role. Hu Huiwen, our master’s classmate, has prior experience as a primary school teacher, and Yang Yunni had previously played a similar maternal role in her acting career.



*Figure 2.5 Nur Farhani Samantha Woodford Binti Mohd Tajudin (Penny)*



*Figure 2.6 Yang Yunni (Penny's Mother)*



*Figure 2.7 Aaron Yap (Male Trainer)*



*Figure 2.8 Hu Huiwen (Female Trainer)*

Before filming, I held discussions with each actor and actress to explain the shots we planned to take and the basic schedule of the two shooting days.

### 2.5.2 Location Scouting

There are mainly three locations involved in this project, namely Infinite Minds Academy, an apartment at Trion, Kuala Lumpur, and the auditorium of the Department of Media and Communication Studies at Universiti Malaya.

As mentioned in previous sections, we visited Infinite Minds Academy two times for different purposes. We paid the first visit for a meeting session with Aaron Yap for confirming our creative directions and collaborative possibilities. Scouting every nook and cranny of usable space is the main goal of the second visit. As shown in figures 2.12 to 2.15, while scouting in the location, I pictured how I could utilize the elements in the background to enhance the immersive experience for the audience without losing continuity. There are units that belong to IMA, yet they are separated in different levels. For example, the entrance of IMA is on the 5$^{th}$ floor of the building, but the ideal classroom is on the 4$^{th}$ floor in the same building. In order to ensure continuity and consistency of the film, I planned the camera angles and positions to avoid showing too much of the background. It would then bring convenience to the narrative building during post-production by connecting two scenes coherently, for instance, the entering scene and the conversation in the office.




*Figure 2.9 The entrance of IMA*



*Figure 2.10 IMA Classroom*




*Figure 2.11 IMA Office*

Another location takes place in an apartment at Trion, Kuala Lumpur. We had never visited the place before, yet we spent a good amount of time searching for the best location for Penny's room scene. We searched on Booking.com to find rental apartments that are in Kuala Lumpur and laid our eyes on the rooms in Trion (see figure 2.12). The rooms in Trion are simple and clean, and they mostly fit our requirements—a table, a kitchen, and a bedroom. We booked one room for 3 days and 2 nights for the convenient logistics.



*Figure 2.12 Apartment overview*

As master’s students taking a media studies program, we go to the auditorium of our department nearly every Friday. During the location scouting, we discovered that the auditorium would be perfect for an award-winning scene if we planned it right. We could easily finish the scene where Penny enters the stage and takes the trophy while the audience cheers and applauds if we chose a day when all of our master's friends were present and there was no lecture or meeting. We confirmed with the head of department, Professor Dr. Md Azalanshah Md Syed, for the permission to shoot before the actual filming.



*Figure 2.13 Auditorium overview*

Site visits allowed us to assess practical factors such as available space, lighting conditions, background noise, and camera placement. We made some adjustments to the storyboard and shot list after these visits as certain locations presented limitations that had not been anticipated earlier.

### 2.5.3 Resource Preparation and Budgeting

In addition to casting and location planning, we prepared equipment and props according to the script and the budget.

Since we only have interior scenes, we prepared equipment accordingly. I used a Sony A6400 camera with its original 16mm–50mm wide lens. It allows me to shoot normal shot sizes while clearly separating foreground and background. Ren was responsible for borrowing equipment from the department, including a

shotgun microphone, a stereo recording microphone, a reflector, and a clapperboard. Meanwhile, Arun was responsible for allocating bigger equipment, such as a camera tripod and a light with a stand.




*Figure 2.14 Sony A6400*




*Figure 2.15 Microphones, clapper board, and reflector*




*Figure 2.16 Camera tripod*



*Figure 2.17 Lighting*

Except for the equipment, we also prepared props for the purpose of creating symbols and enhancing the immersive experience for the audience.

The props include a lion plush toy, a lion roly-poly toy, a sketchbook, colored pencils, a poster of the drawing competition, and printed drawings that are related to the lion figure. The lion in our project symbolizes Penny's inner growth and Penny herself. It came from the initial idea of Mr. Lion during script development. We simplified it into a symbol throughout the film. It appears when Penny is nervous, sad, overwhelmed, happy, and even disappointed. We created the drawings ourselves so that the actress portraying Penny could act as though she could even if she did not know how to draw.



*Figure 2.18 Lion plush*



*Figure 2.19 Sketch book and drawings*




*Figure 2.20 Poster*

## 2.6 Pre-production Challenges and Solutions

The completion of pre-production was not smooth sailing. We encountered several challenges and obstacles that eventually led us to learn and resolve.

During the whole pre-production stage, the production plan has been revised many times. Factors such as location availability, participant plans, and team commitments sometimes require changes to the original plan.

For example, we made about three revisions to our script. There used to be five characters with a variety of thematic narratives, such as identity, inner support, and mother's love, but now there is more emphasis on Penny and her experience. We found a solution by reducing the number of focal points to just one in order to keep the short film from telling too much in the allotted time.

Another example: Aaron was free on Thursday, May 21, while Yang Yunni (playing Penny's Mother) was free on Saturday, May 22, which means that these roles will never meet. We must update the script and shooting schedule in accordance with their timetable. Even though these changes require more work, they help avoid more serious issues during filming.

In general, the pre-production phase of this project gave us a lesson on the importance of preparation. Through documents, actor discussion, location visits, equipment inspection, and time scheduling, many challenges that may interfere with the shooting came up in the early stage. Therefore, the production process can be carried out more smoothly.

# CHAPTER 3: PRODUCTION

After several weeks of planning and preparation, the project entered the production stage. At this point, ideas, scripts, storyboards, and production documents must be translated into actual fragments. The film was filmed in the Infinite Minds Academy, the Trion apartment, and the Universiti Malaya auditorium for two days.

As a director and director of photography, I participated in the most creative and technical decisions in the shooting process. In addition to operating the camera, I also worked closely with actors to monitor visual continuity and adjust the shooting plan in case of accidents.

Although the pre-production stage provides a clear road map, the reality of shooting is often unpredictable. Time constraints, environmental noise, location constraints, and a small staff mean that many decisions must be made quickly on site. Some planned shots were modified, and some successful moments occurred spontaneously during the shooting process.

This chapter discusses the production process, including crew responsibilities, director methods, photographic choices, challenges encountered in the shooting process, and several creative decisions that led to the final version of Penny's voice.

## 3.1 Production Approach and Crew Responsibilities

The main photography work was completed in two days. The first day mainly focused on the IMA scene and some scenes in the apartment, while the second day covered the scenes of all three locations—the rental apartment, IMA and the auditorium. The shooting schedule is listed in the call list (see Appendix D).

Although we have prepared the detailed storyboard, shot list, and schedule in advance, the production still needs flexibility. The availability of some locations is

limited, and the shooting time of some scenes is longer than expected. IMA was only open for shooting from 3 p.m. to 6 p.m. on Thursday because there were students in class in the afternoon. Due to time constraints, as mentioned in the previous chapter, we could only shoot the scene where Penny interacts with the Male Trainer played by Aaron Yap first since Aaron would not be available on Friday. Therefore, the team often needs to adjust our plans and ensure that important scenarios can still be completed on time.

My role combines the duties of director and photography director. I directed the performance, operated the camera, determined the lens composition, and monitored the visual consistency of each scene. Arun Kumar A/L Rajendran served as the gaffer and assisted in light preparation, while Ren Yuhang was responsible for sound recording and supporting general production tasks such as operating the slate.




*Figure 3.1 Shooting in IMA*



*Figure 3.2 Shooting in Trion apartment*

Due to the small size of the team, everyone's work often exceeds the assigned role. Team members usually helped move devices, organized props, monitored continuity, and assisted actors in coordination. Although the shooting process was understaffed, this collaborative way of working helped us complete the shooting efficiently.

By the end of production, about 125 shots had been recorded. For a variety of reasons, more shots were taken overall than the initial shot list, which included roughly 76 planned shots. For example, in order to maintain continuity, additional shots were taken to see both sides of the conversation. These additional shots and takes later become useful during editing in the post-production phase, especially when dealing with continuity issues and scene transitions.

## 3.2 Directing Performance and Working with Actors

Directing and acting is one of my main responsibilities in the production process. Because Penny is basically a nonverbal character, most of the storytelling relies on facial expressions, body language, emotional reactions, and

even other characters' dialogue rather than Penny's oral dialogue. Therefore, the performance with details has become very important to the success of the film.

I no longer focus on what actors should or should not do physically but spend time explaining the emotions behind each scene in the context of autism. Before filming, I discussed Penny's character, struggle, and emotional state with Hani (Penn's actress). I expected her to understand how the character feels in different situations, rather than simply memorizing actions or reactions. For scenes involving sensory overload or anxiety, I explained that autistic adolescents may experience a noisy, unfamiliar or unbearable environment. Research shows that sensory sensitivity is a common feature of many autistic patients, which affects their response to environmental stimuli and social situations (Armstrong, 2010, pp. 50 – 53). Understanding these experiences will help guide the direction of performance and help to describe Penny's emotional reactions more accurately. Therefore, before shooting, I asked the actress to watch some videos about autistic children and adolescents in order to better understand Penny's character.

A scene requiring special attention occurred when Penny rushed into the office while having a mental breakdown. In this scene, she rushed to her mother and silently sought comfort. After hearing the Female Trainer's comfort, she gradually quieted down and hid behind her mother's shoulder. The blocking and facial expression details were difficult to control in this shot. We did many takes to achieve the emotional transition we expect.

Working with actors made me realize that directors are usually about communication rather than guidance. Different actors respond to different approaches. In cases like our two days of shooting, discussing emotions and motivations produces better results than giving high-tech guidance. Once actors understand why a character behaves in a certain way, their performance usually becomes more natural and believable.

The experience of directing and communicating has strengthened my confidence as a director. It shows me that powerful performance comes from more than detailed instructions. They usually come from helping actors understand the emotional purpose behind the scene and giving them enough space to explain in their own way.

### 3.3 Cinematography and Visual Execution

As a director of photography, I am responsible for deciding how to present the story on the screen. Since *The Voice of Penny* mainly focuses on Penny's emotions and personal experience, the choice, position, angle, and action of the camera have been crucial to the storytelling process.

In the process of shooting, I paid attention to framing, composition, and lens movement. The background in IMA is full of different colors. This has been my main concern because when I design Penny's negative emotions, I should avoid using warm colors in the background. However, I can find the best position to frame as few colors as possible for isolated scenes and as warm as possible when Penny painted alone happily.

Many camera choices are based on Penny's emotional state. When she feels anxious or at a loss, I often use the hand-held lens. The slight movement of the camera creates a sense of instability that matches what the character has experienced. For example, when I took a point-of-view (POV) shot where Penny is at the front of the classroom, I intentionally used a handheld camera to stimulate Penny’s eyesight — looking down to her lion plush and being overwhelmed by the applause. The movement of the hand-held camera is not just a choice of style. Instead, it aims to visually externalize Penny's emotional state, allowing the audience to experience the uncertainty and sensory discomfort next to the characters. This approach supports my broader goal of

expressing autism through subjective experience rather than external observation.



*Figure 3.1 Handheld shot*

Since the equipment is relatively simple, I had to carefully consider how to make full use of the existing equipment. For instance, for the POV scene where Aaron is observing Penny from a distance, I moved to the long end of the camera and stood far from Penny. A focal length close to 50mm helps to separate the theme from the background and guide the audience's attention. A wider focus is more useful when displaying Penny's surroundings or her relationship with other characters.

I did not take every shot exactly as planned. Some storyboard frameworks look good on paper, but once we reach the actual location, they are difficult to execute. IMA's classrooms and rented apartments are limited in space. Instead of enforcing the original plan, I adjusted the camera position according to the situation. For example, I changed the original corridor scene to an office scene, where there are more space and the background or ambient noise is minimized. In this case, the modified version works better than the original storyboard.

One of the clips that impressed me was the shot in the auditorium of the Department of media and communication at the University of Malaya. After getting the permission to use the site, I noticed that many students were already sitting inside. I explained to the audience about our project and asked for their cooperation to cheer and clap. After the recording began, Arun made the cue,

the audience offered sincere applause and cheers. We were not directing every response. The reaction of the audience is natural, which gives the energy of a scene, which is difficult to rebuild with a small group of actors.

I am also particularly satisfied with a shot that I designed involving the Male Trainer and Penny. Instead of going directly to her, the Male Trainer put his hand on the table and slid a sketchbook across the table. This action lasted only a few seconds, but it quietly revealed the relationship between the two characters. It implies patience and understanding through simple dialogue and subtle actions. Such scenes remind me that small visual details are often more illustrative than lengthy explanations.



*Figure 3.4 Sliding sketchbook shot*

### 3.4 Production Challenges and Adaptation

When planning production, I think equipment or actor scheduling will be the biggest challenge. However, once filming started, time became the issue that caused us the most pressure.

Our first shooting day took place at Infinite Minds Academy. Since the academy is still operating as a learning center, we could not simply occupy the space for the whole day. Most of our filming had to take place after classes at 3 o’clock in the afternoon. In reality, we only had around three hours to shoot a large number of scenes. Which honestly was not much time at all. Because of

this, many shots had to be completed quickly. There were moments where I wanted another take, or wanted to try a different camera angle, but there simply was not enough time. In those situations, I had to decide whether the shot was good enough to move on. Sometimes it was frustrating, but finishing the scene was more important than chasing a perfect shot. However, on the second shooting day, we were able to use the rooms starting from 12 p.m. to 6 p.m., which gave us much more time to finish every shot left in the IMA scene.

The environment has also created some problems. IMA not a film studio. There are students, teaching staff, conversations, and activities around. Even if we found a relatively quiet space, the background noise would appear unexpectedly. During the shooting, we tried our best to reduce it. However, I knew during shooting that some recordings require extra work in editing.

Another challenge is continuity. We did not arrange a position of a script supervisor, which later led me to some obstacles. I realized that everyone was busy doing other things. I was operating the camera and directing. Ren was handling the shotgun microphone and being ready at any time. Arun was helping with the lighting. When everyone was focused on their tasks, it was easy to ignore small continuity details. Finally, we found a way to mark all the good shots in our pre-production documents, such as shot lists and shooting scripts.

Most challenges were not surprising. To my surprise, they appeared so quickly at the beginning of the filming process. Pre-production phase has solved many problems, but production has brought new problems.

### 3.5 Reflection on Production Decisions

One thing I realized in the production process is that film production often involves compromise. Before shooting, I imagined that every scene and shot would be shot exactly as planned. Once production starts, this is obviously unrealistic.

Due to time constraints, some shots completed are fewer than I originally planned. Sometimes, I noticed some small technical problems but decided to continue because the performance felt real and rare. At the same time, this decision is not always easy. Putting myself in the shoes of the filmmaker, I would naturally hope that every shot has the strongest version. However, I have come to realize that emotional influence is often more important than technical perfection.

This becomes especially important when working with actors. If a performance feels real, I will accept minor flaws in the framework or continuity. In contrast, a technically perfect shot will still feel weak if it lacks emotion. During the production process, I found that I paid more attention to performance and story telling than expected.

Another lesson involves preparation. Storyboards, shot lists, and shooting schedules help us stay organized, but they do not eliminate unexpected problems. Location constraints, background noise and time pressures continue to affect production. What the planning process really provides is a starting point from which adjustments can be made when necessary.

The production stage also changed my understanding of being a director. Before this project, I often linked guidance with instructions. During the shooting process, I found that communication was more important. Actors usually respond better when they understand the purpose of a scene rather than simply being told what to do.

In general, the production process enhances the significance of flexibility. While planning is still necessary, the ability to adapt to changing circumstances is equally important to the completion of the project.

# CHAPTER 4: POST-PRODUCTION

Post-production is the stage where I personally contribute the most to the project. In addition to my duties during shooting, I was mainly responsible for editing, sound design, music creation, color grading, and publicity material design. This stage includes a series of creative and technical processes to transform the original clip into a coherent and emotionally attractive short film. Based on the feedback, several rough cuts were produced and improved, and original music, sound effects, and color processing were developed to enhance the narrative effect of the film. This chapter discusses the post-production workflow and evaluates the creative decision to shape the final version of Penny's voice.

## 4.1 Editing and Narrative Assembly

Post-production will begin immediately after shooting. As the editor of the project, I am responsible for organizing the film, assembling the scene, refining the narrative structure, and preparing for the final delivery. About 125 shots were recorded in two production days. They were first organized according to the scene, location, and shooting date, and then imported into Adobe Premiere Pro.

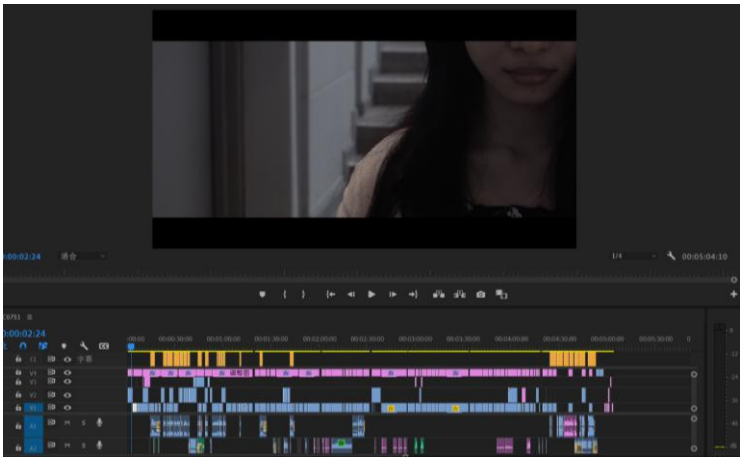


*Figure 4.1 Editing process on Adobe Premiere Pro*

My initial editing approach focused on assembling the narrative according to the screenplay. I gave particular attention to the film's structure, which opens with Penny standing on stage before transitioning into a flashback set three months earlier. This sequence was intentionally designed as a narrative hook to capture audience attention before revealing the events that led to the final competition.



*Figure 4.2 Opening scene—Penny holds the plush*




*Figure 4.3 Transition scene—Penny holds the plush*

The first rough cut lasted about 7 minutes and 20 seconds, much more than the expected 3 to 5 minutes. At this stage, the primary task was to save the story information, rather than control the rhythm. Although the narration was complete,

several scenes felt unnecessarily long and reduced the overall momentum of the film.

The feedback from our supervisor provided an important turning point. One of her key observations is that some scenes lack emotional impact, especially those involving Penny. We discussed the manner of whether we could reshoot or not; the conclusion is that the schedule restrictions made additional shooting impractical. Therefore, I focused on strengthening emotional participation through editing decisions, rather than returning to the production stage.

One of the most difficult decisions was to remove the scene where Penny's mother reviewed her work. Although this scene contains meaningful character interaction, repeated viewing shows that it greatly slows down the speed of narration. Narrative economy must prioritize emotional development and story motivation even though the deleted scenes contain valuable character information.

Finally, I produced three rough cuts. The first is to focus on narrative combination; the second is to refine the structure and dialogue, and the third is to integrate sound design and music. After the postproduction is completed, the running time is reduced from about 7 minutes and 20 seconds to 5 minutes and 4 seconds, including credits.

The editing process emphasizes the importance of evaluating the film based on its contribution to the story rather than the effort required to produce the film. Many of the most powerful improvements in the film were not made by adding material but by carefully deciding which content matters the least.

### 4.2 Sound Design and Audio

Sound design is developed at the same time as editing and plays an important role in shaping the film atmosphere and enhancing the immersive experience.

Since *The Voice of Penny* largely depends on visual storytelling and limited dialogue, voice has become an important tool to support emotion, sense of reality, and continuity.

The first stage of audio post-production focuses on dialogue cleanup. There are several scenes that contain background dialogue and environmental noise that cannot be completely avoided during the shooting process, especially in the IMA. Removing unwanted noise has proved to be challenging because too much processing often affects the clarity of the sound. My goal was not to eliminate every trace of ambient sound but to strike a balance between clarity and naturalness.

I then worked additional sound layers through the software and added sound effects. I recorded some effects with my microphone, including pencil scratches, paper turning, and clothes movement. Other sounds, such as footsteps and selected writing effects, are from online libraries when appropriate recordings cannot be produced internally.

The ambient room tone is also used to improve the continuity between shots recorded under different conditions. These subtle background layers help maintain a consistent sound environment and reduce the impact of burst audio conversion.

The last stage is to balance dialogue, sound effects, atmosphere, and music in Adobe Premiere Pro. To make the sound and conversation more natural, a short attenuation effect was added to the track where the sound was suddenly too large or too small. Feedback from Mini Viva indicates that some music clips are difficult to hear in certain parts of the film, even though the overall sound design effectively supports narration. This observation emphasizes the importance of testing audio mixing across multiple playback environments before final delivery.

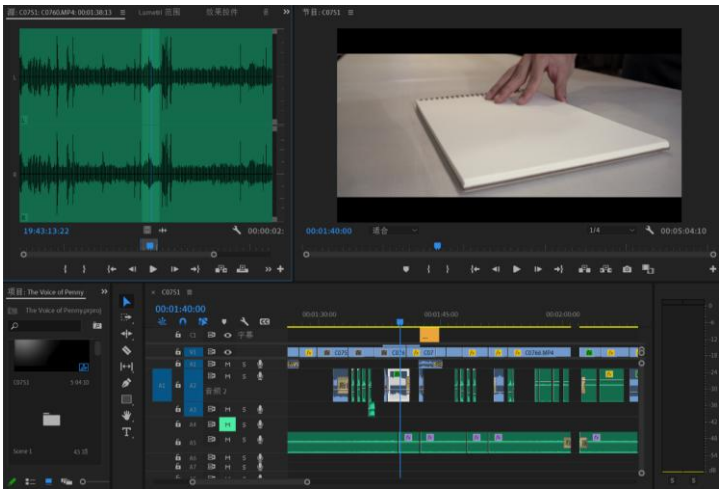


*Figure 4.4 Sound designing process*

Experience has shown that sound design goes beyond technical modifications. It is significant to receive feedbacks before the final delivery. Effective audio post-production directly contributes to immersion, atmosphere, and audience participation.

## 4.3 Music Composing and Scoring

In addition to editing and sound design, I was also responsible for creating original music for the film. I chose to create original works instead of relying on royalty-free tracks because I believed they would provide greater flexibility for the emotional development of the film.

The original soundtrack was created by FL Studio, mainly relying on the sound of piano and violin. I deliberately keep the instrument simple so that the music can support narration without overwhelming dialogue, sound effects, or visual stories.




*Figure 4.5 Music composition in FL Studio*

The development of different music themes to match Penny's emotional journey. Scenes involving uncertainty, isolation, or anxiety usually use small chords and melodies, while moments related to self-confidence and personal growth use brighter chords and more energetic musical movements. This development reflects the wider emotional development of the characters in the whole film.

Shortly before the scene where Penny finishes her last artwork for the final drawing competition, I paid special attention to one musical piece. At this stage of the story, the character has begun to overcome many of her insecurities. Music was designed to convey hope, determination, and optimism without becoming too dramatic. Of all the music works created for this project, this is still my most satisfactory track, because it effectively supports the emotional transformation on the screen.

Before this project, I have composed music independently for several years, and I am familiar with music creation. However, film creation needs different perspectives. The goal is no longer to create an independent musical work but to support storytelling. This experience strengthened my understanding of how music interacts with pacing, performance, and visual narrative.

## 4.4 Color Grading and Visual Tone

Color grading was completed in Adobe Premiere Pro using Lumetri Color. Unlike some aspects of the project that were planned during pre-production, the overall color strategy emerged gradually during editing as I reviewed the film's emotional progression.

Two main steps I took for color grading: one is color correction, or primary color grading; the other one is creative color rendering, or secondary color grading. Primary color grading corrects the color from different devices into a standard parameter. By doing so, the color of the footage would be close to the image seen by a human eye. Secondary color grading deals with creativity. It creates styles and diversity based on the taste of the editor or the director.




*Figure 4.6 Primary color grading interface*




*Figure 4.7 Secondary color grading interface*

Three visual stages eventually became apparent. The first utilized cooler tones to support scenes involving anxiety, isolation, and sensory discomfort. These moments primarily occur during the early stages of the story when Penny struggles to adapt to unfamiliar environments and social situations.



*Figure 4.8 Cool tones*

As Penny became more and more involved in painting and artistic expression, warm tones were introduced. These scenes emphasize comfort, introspection, and personal growth and form a visual contrast with the early parts of the film.



*Figure 4.9 Warm tones*

The last stage uses a warm golden tone at the end of the narration. At this time, Penny has gained confidence and is willing to share her work openly. Therefore, the color evolution from cold to warm reflects the emotional movement from uncertainty to self-expression and achievement.




*Figure 4.10 Golden tones-Penny holds a trophy and the lion plush*



*Figure 4.11 Golden tones—Penny hugs her Mother*

Instead of relying on the preset LUT, I manually performed the color adjustment to maintain the consistency of position and lighting conditions. This method provides greater flexibility and allows visual style and narration to develop organically.

## 4.5 Promotional Materials and Poster Design

In addition to my film production duties, I also designed publicity materials for the Momentus 2026 exhibition and the film. As the first introduction to the project, these materials are critical in shaping the expectations of the audience before watching.

I produced two separate posters for different purposes (see Figure 4.1 and Figure 4.2). The main function of the Momentus 2026 exhibition poster is to provide information and display the objectives, background, customer information, and Instagram QR code access of our group posts.

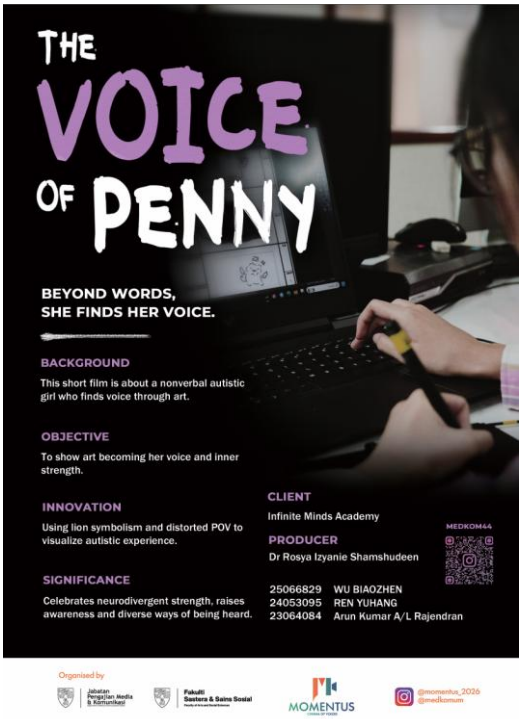



*Figure 4.12 Poster for the Momentus 2026 exhibition*

In contrast, the poster of the promotional film gives priority to emotional input and visual identity.

The movie poster uses a close-up image of pennies next to the performance of stroke graphics and stylized typography. The design aims to convey the theme of creativity, self-expression and personality, while maintaining consistency with the overall aesthetics of the film. Although these two posters represent the same project, they are aimed at different audience needs and show the importance of adapting visual communication to specific environment.

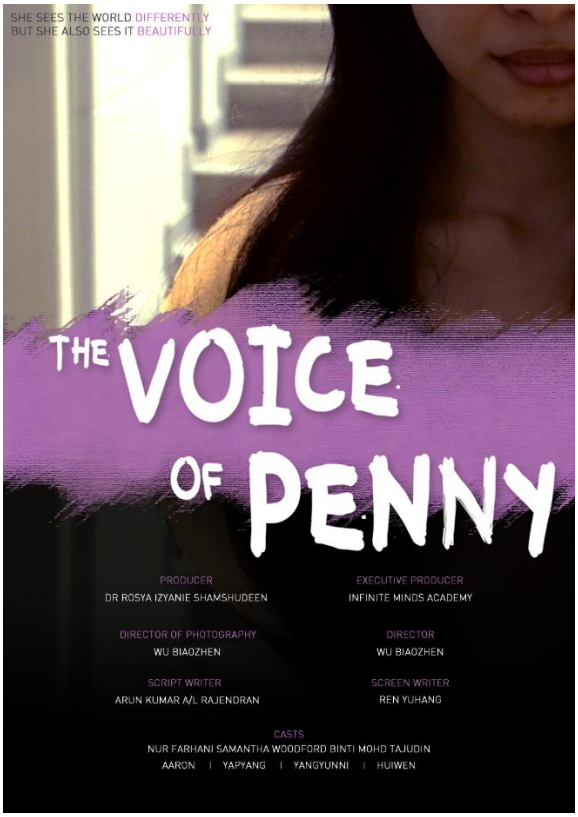



*Figure 4.13 Poster for the short film: The Voice of Penny*

## 4.6 Feedback, Revisions, and Final Delivery

Feedback plays a key role in the whole post-production process, providing a perspective beyond my own understanding of the project. The most important feedback came from my supervisor when she reviewed the first rough cut. Her

observation of emotional engagement encourages a more critical assessment of rhythm, lens selection, and narrative focus.

After the subsequent revision, the completed film was screened and evaluated during Mini Viva. The external reviewer responded positively to the performance of an autistic patient in the film and described the story as meaningful and emotionally fascinating. At the same time, he pointed out that some aspects of the flashback structure sometimes cause confusion, and some musical elements are difficult to hear clearly.

These reviews provided valuable insights into the differences between creative intent and audience interpretation. Although the people who participated in the production seemed to be very clear about the narrative structure of the story, the experience of the people who watched the story for the first time was different. Similarly, audio decisions that seem effective during editing do not always translate consistently throughout the playback environment.

Our client, Aaron Yap, from IMA was also satisfied with the final result, and then requested to share the film through their social media channel. This response indicated that the completed projects were in line with the values and objectives of the organization.




*Figure 4.14 Aaron Yap's reaction after watching our short film*

Following final revisions and quality checks, the film was exported and prepared for exhibition. By this stage, the project had progressed through multiple script revisions, three rough cuts, extensive audio work, original music composition, colour grading, and promotional design, resulting in the final version of *The Voice of Penny* presented to audiences.

# CHAPTER 5: CONCLUSION

The completion of *The Voice of Penny* provided an opportunity to evaluate both the final outcome of the project and the learning experiences gained throughout its development. While the film achieved many of its intended objectives, the production process also revealed rooms for improvements in future projects. This chapter reflects on the effectiveness of the project in relation to its goals, assesses its creative and technical achievements, identifies limitations encountered during production and post-production, and discusses the personal and professional growth that resulted from undertaking multiple creative roles. This evaluation critically explores the overall contribution that the project has made, and the lessons that it offers to future media productions.

## 5.1 Evaluation of Project Objectives

The main mission of The Voice of Penny was to examine the possibility of artistic expression as a meaningful way of communication for those who are not heard. The project aimed to foster empathy and challenge preconceptions, emphasizing the value of seeing individual qualities through the lens of a nonverbal autistic teenager's story.

From the final output and the input collected during the display and assessment process, I think that these aims were mostly met. Instead of only showing autism as a collection of obstacles or deficits, the movie emphasizes creativity, personal development, and self-expression. Penny's experience proves that there are various ways to communicate, and that significant voices are not always conveyed through spoken words.

The collaboration with Infinite Minds Academy also turned out to be quite useful for the attainment of these aims. Working closely with the organization ensured that the project was consistent with the values of inclusiveness, empowerment and strengths based representation. The client's good feedback

on the finished film suggests that the film is an effective embodiment of those ideas.

This assessment was also reinforced by the external examiner's feedback. The examiner had some constructive comments in terms of the clarity of the narrative and the balance of the audio, but he was enthusiastic about the film's portrayal of an autistic person and found the story significant. This means the project's core message was effectively communicated to audiences.

No creative endeavor can speak to everyone, but The Voice of Penny fulfilled its main goal of offering a respectful and emotionally captivating depiction of a young girl developing confidence via artistic expression.

### 5.2 Evaluation of Creative Outcomes

From a creative point of view, several parts of the project helped improve the end result. One of the best options was to have the story revolve around a mainly nonverbal protagonist. This meant that the film had to express its story through performance, through visual storytelling, through sound and music, rather than through words. Hence more emphasis was paid to the film approaches that allowed emotional involvement.

The recurrent lion emblem also proved to be an excellent creative device. At first, the idea had a more dominant lion persona, but subsequent revisions turned the notion into a visual motif that was used in props and artwork. This method maintained symbolic meaning without detracting from the main story. Original music writing was another strength. As a composer, I was able to write the music of the film in tight alignment with the emotional arc of the plot. This slow transition from serious music themes to more positive and lively ones paralleled Penny's character growth and helped enhance the visual storytelling.

The colour grading method also greatly enhanced the emotional arc of the film. The shift from cooler tones during times of uncertainty to warmer golden tones during the end helped underline ideas of confidence, growth and self-expression.

Responses from audiences, the client and the examiner have shown these creative choices added positively to the viewing experience. The client's wish to distribute the film on the academy's social media channels is a testament to the project's effectiveness in representing the institution and its principles. The reviewer's remarks indicate similarly that the emotional heart of the film remained strong despite some shortcomings in its structure.

Meanwhile, appraising creative products involves recognizing the need for improvement. The flashback pattern worked well to generate initial curiosity, but at times detracted from narrative clarity. Some of the emotional moments might have used more rehearsal or shooting possibilities. These restrictions do not diminish the project's accomplishments but point to areas for future improvement. All in all, the project's creativity is greater than its faults. The blend of storyline, symbols, music, colour and performance all work well to communicate the films intended themes, whilst still retaining a strong focus on Penny's personal journey.

### 5.3 Limitations and Recommendations for Future Improvement

The project had its successes, but also showed up some limitations that had an impact on the process of production and the ultimate result.

One of the most important limitations was the narrative framework. The utilization of a stage sequence at the beginning of the film followed by a flashback worked to build anticipation but confused some first-time viewers. "Future projects with similar structures could use clearer visual cues and more straightforward transitions."

Another area for enhancement was performance development. The emotional impact was very much dependent on subtle acting, as the movie relied so much on nonverbal acting. Several critical scenes may have benefited from more rehearsal time and contingency planning for potential reshoots.

Scheduling of production was also a limiting factor. But the institution's day-to-day operations restricted access to Infinite Minds Academy, which in turn curtailed opportunities for experimentation and repeated takes. The lack of a specialized script supervisor meant that continuity problems on set were more likely.

From a post-production viewpoint, the audio should have been better balanced. The feedback from the examiner was that several musical portions were difficult to hear properly in some parts of the film. This problem did not affect the main story too much, but it did show the significance of evaluating the final mix on several playback platforms.

The experiment also demonstrated the importance of wider audience testing. Most of the comments before submission were from people who were already familiar with the project. Additional screenings for an audience unfamiliar with the story might have highlighted problems with narrative clarity and sound design much earlier in the process.

These constraints were good learning experiences and will be used for future productions. I do not see them as just weaknesses, but as practical insights that help with continuous creative and professional development.

### 5.4 Personal and Professional Development

This project was one of the most all-encompassing creative experiences of my academic career, as I had to take on several duties during different stages of production. As director, director of photography, editor, music composer, and

poster designer, I was engaged in almost every phase of the filming process. As a director, I learned how to turn creative ideas into realistic decisions. Directing isn't only about having a vision; it's about articulating that vision successfully to actors, crew members and partners. It was a great experience and really cemented the need of preparation, flexibility and communication whilst on set.

Being a cinematographer taught me to be a more visual storyteller. I was starting to notice more the way that visual choices affect how an audience perceives and feels things, rather than just seeing framing and camera movement as technical things. This project improved my ability to use cinematography as a storytelling device, rather than simply a means of recording occurrences.

The most important development took place during post-production. Editing required a continuous re-evaluation of every scene, performance and creative decision. I learned that filmmaking is often about what you take away, not what you put in. This experience sharpened my capacity for critical assessment of material and to make decisions that favor the overall success of the narrative over any connection to particular sequences.

Composing the original soundtrack for the film offered me a new creative perspective as well. I had produced music independently before, but this was a whole other ball game, writing for movies. It was never meant to be a solitary piece of music, but to aid in storytelling through emotion, tempo and atmosphere. Designing promotional materials has added a new dimension to creative communication. Posters for the film and for the exhibition involved consideration of audience expectations, visual identity and project branding. My experience has given me a deeper grasp of how films are promoted and presented outside the screen itself.

What we took away from the experience is that diverse creative disciplines are extremely interconnected.” Writing, directing, photography, editing, music and design don’t work in isolation. Decisions at one level will unavoidably affect results at another. Firsthand experience of these relationships gave a far deeper insight into the process of filmmaking than studying individual stages in isolation.

## 5.5 Conclusion

*The Voice of Penny* was started as a reaction to the Momentus 2026 theme “Cinema of Voices” and evolved into a project about communication, creativity and self-expression. The project collaborated with Infinite Minds Academy to develop a positive, strengths-based portrayal of a nonverbal autistic youngster who builds confidence through art.

The project had certain issues around story structure, scheduling, performance and post production but these challenges also resulted in great learning experiences and ultimately increased the end results. The excellent feedback from the client and external examiner indicates that the film has managed to convey its core concepts while staying true to its original intent.

Most crucially, the experiment provided evidence for the premise that voice is not only speech. Through Penny’s experience, the video illustrates that creativity, perseverance and self-expression can be valuable ways of communicating, too. The completion of The Voice of Penny is not merely the end of a filmmaking project but a significant milestone along the way of my development as a creative practitioner.

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# APPENDICES

## Appendix A: Letter of Consent

UNIVERSITI MALAYA

**30 March 2026**

**Aaron Yap**
Infinite Minds Academy
B-3-5, 3 Two Square
Jalan 19/1
Petaling Jaya, Selangor 46300

**Through**

**Assoc. Professor Dr. Md Azalanshah Md Syed**
Head
Department of Media and Communication Studies
Faculty of Arts and Social Sciences
Universiti Malaya

Ketua
Jabatan Pengajian Media dan Komunikasi
Fakulti Sastera dan Sains Sosial
Universiti Malaya
50603 Kuala Lumpur

**REQUEST FOR COLLABORATION ON CREATIVE MEDIA PROJECT**

Dear Aaron,

My name is Wu Biaozhen, and I am a Master of Media Studies student at the Faculty of Arts and Social Sciences, Universiti Malaya. For our AQA7019 Creative Media Project, we will produce a final work for **MOMENTUS**, our yearly graduate exhibition. This year's theme is Cinema of Voices, which focuses on telling stories that help audiences listen more clearly to the voices of people such as users, workers, customers, experts, visitors or residents.

I am writing to request a collaboration with Infinite Minds Academy as our project client. Our project will be developed based on your organisation's needs, and we propose to produce a Short Film. The project will highlight diverse perspectives and amplify the voices of communities whose stories deserve to be heard, in line with the theme Cinema of Voices. If your organisation agrees to collaborate, we kindly request a short confirmation email to confirm that Infinite Minds Academy is willing to be our project client for this course. We will document the project process in a professionally designed Project Book for exhibition, and this confirmation email will be included in the appendix for record purposes.

Thank you for considering this request. I would be happy to share a short project proposal and discuss the project further. You may contact me at 60-179587419 or 25066829@siswa.um.edu.my. I look forward to the opportunity to work together.

Warm regards,

**Wu Biaozhen (25066829)**
Department of Media and Communication Studies
Faculty of Arts and Social Sciences
Universiti Malaya
25066829@siswa.um.edu.my.
60-179587419

## Appendix B: Confirmation Letter of Collaboration

UNIVERSITI MALAYA

Wu Biaozhen <25066829@siswa.um.edu.my>

**Official Intent Letter – Collaboration for AQA7019 Creative Media Project**
2 messages

**Wu Biaozhen** <25066829@siswa.um.edu.my> Mon, Mar 30, 2026 at 10:42 PM
To: AaronYap88@gmail.com

Dear Aaron,

I hope this email finds you well.

Please find attached the official intent letter regarding our collaboration with Infinite Minds Academy for the AQA7019 Creative Media Project. This letter outlines the scope of our project and serves as a formal record for our university's MOMENTUS graduate exhibition.

For documentation purposes, we kindly request that you confirm your agreement to collaborate by replying to this email. A short reply acknowledging the collaboration will be sufficient.

Thank you once again for your support and enthusiasm. We look forward to working together and will keep you updated on our progress.

Please feel free to reach out if you have any questions.

Warm regards,
Wu Biaozhen
(on behalf of Arun Kumar Rajenran & Ren Yuhang)

Department of Media and Communication Studies
Faculty of Arts and Social Sciences
Universiti Malaya
25066829@siswa.um.edu.my
+60 17-9587 419

**Attachments:**

- Intent Letter.pdf

**Intent Letter.pdf**
166K

**Aaron Yap** <aaronyap88@gmail.com> Tue, Mar 31, 2026 at 8:20 AM
To: Wu Biaozhen <25066829@siswa.um.edu.my>

Acknowledging the collaboration, approved

[Quoted text hidden]
[Quoted text hidden]
" PENAFIAN: E-mel ini dan apa-apa fail yang dikepilkan bersamanya ("Mesej") adalah ditujukan hanya untuk kegunaan penerima(-penerima) yang termaklum di atas dan mungkin mengandungi maklumat sulit. Anda dengan ini dimaklumkan bahawa mengambil apa jua tindakan bersandarkan kepada, membuat penilaian, mengulang hantar, menghebah, mengedar, mencetak, atau menyalin Mesej ini atau sebahagian daripadanya oleh sesiapa selain daripada penerima(-penerima) yang termaklum di atas adalah dilarang. Jika anda telah menerima Mesej ini kerana kesilapan, anda mesti menghapuskan Mesej ini dengan segera dan memaklumkan kepada penghantar Mesej ini menerusi balasan e-mel. Pendapat-pendapat, rumusan-rumusan, dan sebarang maklumat lain di dalam Mesej ini yang tidak berkait dengan urusan rasmi Universiti Malaya adalah difahami sebagai bukan dikeluar atau diperakui oleh mana-mana pihak yang disebut.

DISCLAIMER: This e-mail and any files transmitted with it ("Message") is intended only for the use of the recipient(s) named above and may contain confidential information. You are hereby notified that the taking of any action in reliance upon, or any review, retransmission, dissemination, distribution, printing or copying of this Message or any part thereof by anyone other than the intended recipient(s) is strictly prohibited. If you have received this Message in error, you should delete this Message immediately and advise the sender by return e-mail. Opinions, conclusions and other information in this Message that do not relate to the official business of University of Malaya shall be understood as neither given nor endorsed by any of the forementioned. "

## Appendix C: Pre-production Documents

*(a) Script*

The Voice of Penny

written by

Arun Kumar A/L Rajendran

WU Biaozhen

Address: Jalan Kuala Lumpur - Kuantan, 50603 Kuala Lumpur, Wilayah Persekutuan Kuala Lumpur
Phone: 0179587419
E-mail: 25066829@siswa.um.edu.my

**FADE IN:**

**BLACK SCREEN**

LOUD APPLAUSE builds—distorted, overwhelming, almost aggressive.

CAMERA FLASHES pierce the darkness.

1 **INT. AUDITORIUM STAGE - NIGHT** 1

Blinding stage lights.

PENNY (15) stands frozen center stage, holding a trophy tightly.

Sound warps from her perspective:

— applause becomes unbearable noise
— microphone feedback sharp and painful
— crowd visually blurs into pressure and movement

Her breathing tightens.

CLOSE ON: a small LION PLUSH in her hand.

**CUT TO:**

**TITLE CARD: THE VOICE OF PENNY**

**THREE MONTHS EARLIER**

2 **EXT. INFINITE MINDS ACADEMY - MORNING** 2

PENNY holds a small LION PLUSH in her hand.

A calm learning center for neurodivergent students.

PENNY arrives with her MOTHER. She avoids eye contact, gripping her lion plush.

A TRAINER greets them warmly.

**ELLA**
Good morning.

Penny hides slightly behind her mother.

3 **INT. ACADEMY OFFICE - CONTINUOUS** 3

Mother speaks quietly.

**MOTHER**
She gets overwhelmed easily… loud sounds… crowds… she doesn't speak much.

The Trainer nods.

**AARON**
We'll go at her pace.

4 **INT. CLASSROOM - MEANWHILE** 4

Trainer introduces Penny.

**AARON**
Everyone, this is Penny.

Polite applause.

Instantly—

SOUND DISTORTS.

Clapping becomes violent noise.

Chairs scrape. Whispers collide.

Penny covers her ears, panicking.

She runs out.

5 **INT. HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS** 5

Penny collapses into her mother's arms.

Across the hall: a poster.

**"National Digital Youth Art Competition - Entries Open."**

Penny stares.

Something lingers.

**MONTAGE - PENNY ADJUSTING**

— sitting alone in class
— overwhelmed by sound
— clutching lion plush tightly
— observing other students

The world feels too loud.

6 **INT. CLASSROOM - AFTERNOON** 6

Trainer places a sketchbook and crayons on Penny's desk.

**AARON**
You can draw anything.

Silence.

Penny hesitates… then draws.

As pencil touches paper—

**SOUND FADES OUT.**

For the first time, calm.

**MONTAGE - DRAWING PROCESS (CONDENSED)**

— lion sketches filling pages
— distorted sound waves drawn as shapes
— lonely lions in crowded spaces
— Penny drawing late at night
— hiding sketchbook quickly when approached

Her internal world becomes visual language.

7 **INT. CLASSROOM - EVENING** 7

Trainer notices Penny's sketchbook accidentally.

Inside: intense emotional drawings—chaos, sound, isolation, lions.

**AARON**
(softly)
…you don't have to hide this.

Penny immediately shuts the book.

8 **INT. PENNY'S HOME - NIGHT** 8

Mother quietly flips through sketchbook.

Page after page.

Her expression shifts—shock, sadness, understanding.

She looks at Penny with new awareness.

No words needed.

9 **INT. PENNY'S ROOM - NIGHT** 9

Penny stares at the competition poster.

A decision forming.

10 **INT. PENNY'S ROOM - LATER** 10

She tries drawing.

Stops.

Erases.

Rips paper.

Frustration builds.

She collapses.

11 **INT. BATHROOM - NIGHT** 11

Mirror shot.

Something feels off.

Her reflection subtly shifts—

Penny sees herself as a **LION-COSTUMED VERSION** in the mirror.

Still.

Calm.

Her real self breathes heavily.

The lion reflection steadies her gaze.

No fear.

Just focus.

12 **INT. PENNY'S ROOM - NIGHT** 12

Penny begins again.

**MONTAGE - FINAL ART CREATION**

— digital painting
— sketch layering
— paint textures

— sleepless nights
— erasing and rebuilding

The image forms:

A calm lion at the center of chaos.

Surrounding it: fragmented noise, colors, distortion.

But the lion remains still.

Unshaken.

13 **INT. PENNY'S ROOM - NIGHT** 13

Mouse hovering over: **SUBMIT**

Her hand trembles.

Mother places her hand gently over Penny's.

A pause.

CLICK.

**SUBMITTED.**

14 **INT. AUDITORIUM STAGE - NIGHT** 14

HOST at microphone.

**HOST**
The winner of this year's National Digital Youth Art Competition is… Penny.

Applause erupts.

Overwhelming again.

Penny freezes.

But this time—

She stays.

She walks forward.

Step by step.

Her mother watches, emotional.

Penny accepts the trophy.

Clutches her lion plush.

Applause intensifies.

Then—

She raises the trophy.

Her hands subtly transform into LION PAWS.

Strong.

Stable.

Present.

The sound softens.

Penny stands still under the spotlight.

A small smile forms.

**MOTHER (V.O.)**
Penny may see the world
differently…
but she taught us there are many
ways to be heard.

**FADE OUT.**

**THE END**

## *(b)* Treatment

# Treatment

**Logline**

A nonverbal autistic teenager overwhelmed by the noise and chaos of the world discovers a powerful identity through art. As she struggles to express herself publicly, a symbolic vision of herself as a lion helps her find the courage to finally be seen and heard.

---

**Act 1 — Overwhelmed**

The film opens in darkness.

Thunderous applause slowly fills the screen.

Bright stage lights flash violently across blurred faces. Camera flashes explode through a crowded auditorium. At the center of the stage stands PENNY (15), frozen beneath a spotlight while gripping a trophy tightly in her hands.

The sound distorts from Penny's perspective.

Applause crashes unnaturally loudly.
Microphone feedback pierces the air.
Voices overlap into incomprehensible noise.

Penny's breathing becomes shallow.

Her fingers tighten around a small lion toy hanging from the trophy.

CUT TO BLACK.

TITLE CARD:
**Three Months Earlier**

Morning sunlight fills the grounds of Infinite Minds Academy, a learning center for neurodivergent children. Children move through hallways while trainers guide activities patiently. Artwork decorates the walls with bright colors and handprints.

Penny arrives with her MOTHER (40s), clinging tightly to her sleeve while avoiding eye contact with everyone around her. Attached to Penny's bag is a small worn lion plush.

A TRAINER warmly welcomes them while another Trainer speaks privately with Penny's mother nearby.

The mother quietly explains:
Penny struggles with communication, becomes overwhelmed easily, and often panics in noisy environments.

Inside the classroom, students turn toward Penny curiously.

The Trainer introduces her.

The students clap politely.

Instantly, the room changes from Penny's perspective.

Hands slam together aggressively.
Chairs scrape loudly.
Whispers blur together.
Movements feel chaotic and threatening.

Penny grips the lion plush tightly against her chest as her breathing quickens. Unable to process the overwhelming environment, she rushes out of the classroom.

Outside, she collapses into her mother's arms.

The Trainer gently reassures her mother:
Penny simply needs patience, trust, and time.

As Penny rests against her mother's shoulder, her eyes drift toward a poster hanging in the hallway:

**"National Digital Youth Art Competition — Entries Open."**

The poster features a colorful lion illustration surrounded by abstract paint strokes.

Penny quietly stares at it.

Something about the lion captures her attention.

---

**Act 2 — Expression**

Days pass.

Penny continues struggling to adapt to the academy. While other students socialize naturally, she remains isolated and withdrawn.

One afternoon, the Trainer quietly sits beside her and places a sketchbook and crayons nearby.

"You can draw anything you want."

Penny hesitates before slowly opening the sketchbook.

Close-up shots capture:
fingers brushing across crayons,
blank pages waiting,
pencil touching paper.

As she begins drawing, the surrounding classroom noise gradually fades into silence.

For the first time, Penny appears calm.

Days become weeks.

Drawing becomes Penny’s emotional language — a safe space where she can express feelings she cannot verbalize.

But strangely, every drawing is from the perspective of a lion.

The audience gradually notices:

- crowded hallways viewed from low lion eyes,
- distorted human figures surrounding a lion,
- abstract sound waves attacking the frame,
- a lonely lion isolated among chaos,
- lions sitting silently while the world blurs violently around them.

The lion becomes Penny’s emotional reflection.

She carries the sketchbook everywhere:
inside classrooms,
at home,
late at night on the couch.

Whenever someone gets too close, she immediately hides the drawings.

One evening after class, Penny remains alone, deeply focused on drawing.

The Trainer quietly returns and accidentally glimpses several pages.

Inside are emotionally powerful illustrations:
fragmented crowds,
violent colors,
distorted sound,
and lions standing silently at the center of chaos.

The Trainer is speechless.

Startled, Penny immediately closes the sketchbook and clutches it tightly.

The Trainer softly reassures her:
“You don’t have to hide this.”

Later that evening, Penny’s mother carefully flips through the drawings.

As she studies them, her expression slowly changes from confusion to heartbreak and pride.

For the first time, she understands how Penny experiences the world.

Weeks later, Penny walks past the competition poster again.

This time, she stops longer.

Quietly, she decides to participate.

---

**Act 3 — Becoming the Lion**

That night, Penny sits alone at home, surrounded by blank papers and unfinished sketches.

For the first time since she began drawing, she cannot draw anything.

She feels frustrated.
Confused.
Lost.

Every attempt is abandoned.

Crushed papers slowly pile around her.

The pressure of expressing herself publicly overwhelms her.

Late at night, Penny walks toward the bathroom sink and stares into the mirror.

Something feels wrong.

The reflection appears slightly distorted.

Penny leans closer, trying to see clearly.

Then—

inside the reflection only—

Penny sees herself wearing a lion costume.

Not cartoonish.
Not imaginary.

Powerful.
Silent.
Still.

Real Penny immediately looks down at her own hands.

Still human.

She slowly raises her eyes back toward the mirror.

Lion Penny stares directly at her.

At first, the lion expression mirrors Penny's confusion.

Then gradually—

the lion version of Penny becomes calm.
Focused.

Determined.

The lion does not speak.

But somehow, Penny understands.

The reflection feels fearless.

Penny’s breathing steadies.

Her real-life expression slowly changes as well.

Determination replaces fear.

She returns to her desk.

And begins drawing.

A montage follows:
paint splashing,
digital sketching,
erasing,
restarting,
late nights,
focused concentration.

The final artwork slowly comes together:

At the center sits a lion —
calm,
strong,
unmoving.

Around it:
violent abstract shapes,

fragmented crowds,
distorted colors,
chaotic sound-like textures swirling endlessly.

Yet the lion remains grounded in the middle.

Silent.
But powerful.

The painting becomes Penny's message to the world:
even surrounded by overwhelming noise and confusion,
she still exists with dignity and strength.

Like lotus flowers blooming unstained from muddy waters.

Eventually, Penny submits the artwork.

---

**Act 4 — Being Heard**

Weeks later, Penny and her mother attend the competition exhibition held inside a crowded auditorium.

Immediately, the environment overwhelms her again:
bright stage lights,
camera flashes,
echoing voices,
crowds moving endlessly.

The sensory overload mirrors the opening scene.

But this time, Penny notices something different.

Visitors stand silently before her artwork.

People study it emotionally.

Some quietly wipe tears away.
Others photograph the painting carefully.

Without speaking,
Penny realizes:
people finally understand her.

Then her name is announced.

Penny slowly walks toward the stage.

Thunderous applause fills the auditorium once again.

For a brief moment, she freezes beneath the lights.

But she does not run.

She looks toward her mother in the audience.

Her mother smiles proudly through tears.

Penny receives the trophy.

The applause grows louder.

This time, instead of shrinking away—

Penny slowly raises the trophy high above her head.

At that exact moment—

her hands visually transform into lion paws once again.

Not frightening.

Empowering.

The applause suddenly softens.

For the first time in her life, Penny no longer appears overwhelmed by the noise around her.

Because she finally understands:
she does not need to become like everyone else to be strong.

She already is.

As Penny stands beneath the spotlight, her mother's voice is heard softly in narration:

"Penny may see the world differently…
but she taught us there are many ways to be heard."

FADE TO BLACK.

THE END.

(c) Storyboard

**The Voice of Penny**
**Storyboard**

SCENE 1

SHOT 1




Shot Type: BLACK SCREEN
Action: Pure black frame.
SFX: Distorted applause slowly rising.
Storyboard Focus: Empty darkness with overwhelming sound atmosphere.

SHOT 2




Shot Type: EXTREME CLOSE UP
Action: Bright camera flashes strobing in darkness from Penny's POV.
Camera: Abstract fragmented light.
SFX: Applause intensifies.
Storyboard Focus: Harsh flashes cutting through blackness.

SHOT 3




Shot Type: WIDE SHOT
Action: Penny frozen center stage under giant spotlight.
Camera: Wide auditorium composition.
SFX: Loud warped applause.
Storyboard Focus: Tiny isolated girl in huge stage space.

SHOT 4




Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Penny tense and overwhelmed.
Camera: Tight facial framing.
SFX: Muffled distorted sound.
Storyboard Focus: Anxiety in eyes and facial tension.

SHOT 5




Shot Type: INSERT SHOT
Action: Trophy shaking in her hands.
Camera: Tight insert on hands.
SFX: Sharp audio spike.
Storyboard Focus: Trembling fingers gripping trophy.

SHOT 6



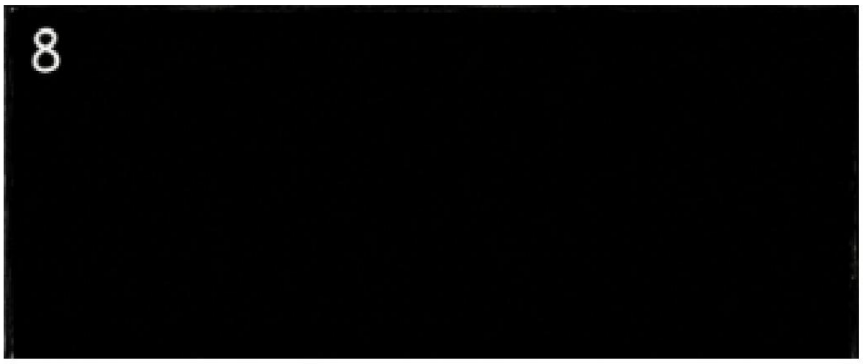

Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Lion plush squeezed tightly.
SFX: Sound briefly drops.
Storyboard Focus: Plush symbolizes safety.

SHOT 7




Shot Type: POV SHOT
Action: Audience distorted and blurry.
Camera: Fish-eye / warped perspective.
SFX: Audio distortion peaks.
Storyboard Focus: Sensory overload visualization.

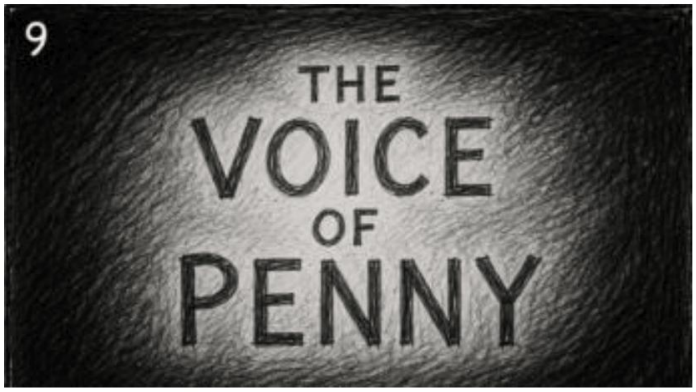
SHOT 8




Shot Type: CUT TO BLACK
Action: Instant black frame.
SFX: Silence.
Storyboard Focus: Sudden relief.

## SCENE 2

SHOT 9




Shot Type: TITLE CARD
Action: “THE VOICE OF PENNY”
SFX: Silence

SHOT 10




Shot Type: TITLE CARD
Action: “THREE MONTHS EARLIER”
SFX: Soft ambient tone begins.

## SCENE 3

SHOT 11




Shot Type: ESTABLISHING SHOT
Action: Infinite Minds Academy exterior in morning light.
SFX: Birds, soft ambience.
Storyboard Focus: Calm peaceful environment.

SHOT 12




Shot Type: MEDIUM SHOT
Action: Penny arrives with mother holding lion plush.
SFX: Low ambient noise.
Storyboard Focus: Penny hiding slightly behind mother.

SHOT 13




Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Penny avoiding eye contact.
SFX: Subtle anxiety tone.
Storyboard Focus: Nervous expression.

SHOT 14




Shot Type: MEDIUM SHOT
Action: Trainer warmly greets them.
SFX: Normal dialogue ambience.
Storyboard Focus: Warm welcoming body language.

## SCENE 4

SHOT 15




Shot Type: TWO SHOT
Action: Mother talks quietly with trainer.
SFX: Soft dialogue.

SHOT 16




Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Mother expressing concern.
SFX: Muted environment.
Storyboard Focus: Emotional protective expression.

SHOT 17




Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Trainer nodding gently.
SFX: Calm tone.

SHOT 18




Shot Type: TRACKING SHOT
Action: Penny guided through hallway.
SFX: Soft footsteps echo.
Storyboard Focus: Slow hesitant movement.

SCENE 5

SHOT 19




Shot Type: WIDE SHOT
Action: Full classroom, students seated.
SFX: Normal classroom ambience.

SHOT 20




Shot Type: MEDIUM SHOT
Action: Trainer introducing Penny.
SFX: Clear dialogue.

SHOT 21




Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Students politely clapping.
SFX: Applause begins.

SHOT 22




Shot Type: SOUND SHIFT SHOT
Action: Visual instability and blur begin.
Camera: Slight handheld shake.
SFX: Applause becomes harsh.

SHOT 23




Shot Type: POV SHOT
Action: Students seem too close and distorted.
SFX: Audio distortion increases.
Storyboard Focus: Claustrophobic composition.

SHOT 24




Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Penny covering ears.
SFX: Heavy breathing.

SHOT 25




Shot Type: HANDHELD SHOT
Action: Penny suddenly stands up.
SFX: Chaotic sound peak.

SHOT 26




Shot Type: TRACKING SHOT
Action: Penny runs out classroom.
SFX: Chairs scraping loudly.

SCENE 6

SHOT 27




Shot Type: MEDIUM SHOT
Action: Penny collapses into mother’s arms.
SFX: Sound dampened.

SHOT 28




Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Mother comforting Penny.
SFX: Soft dialogue.

SHOT 29




Shot Type: INSERT SHOT
Action: Art competition poster on wall.
SFX: Quiet ambience.

SHOT 30




Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Penny staring at poster.
SFX: Subtle tonal shift.
Storyboard Focus: Spark of curiosity.

SCENE 7

SHOT 31




Shot Type: WIDE SHOT
Action: Penny isolated outside classroom.
SFX: Ambient noise.

SHOT 32



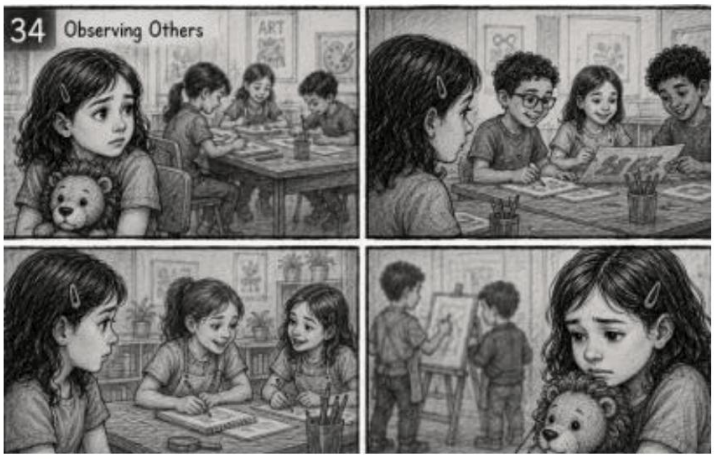

Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Covering ears.
SFX: Distant noise.

SHOT 33




Shot Type: INSERT
Action: Plush in hand.
SFX: Quiet.

SHOT 34




Shot Type: SERIES OF SHOTS
Action: Penny silently observing classmates.
SFX: Minimal sound bed

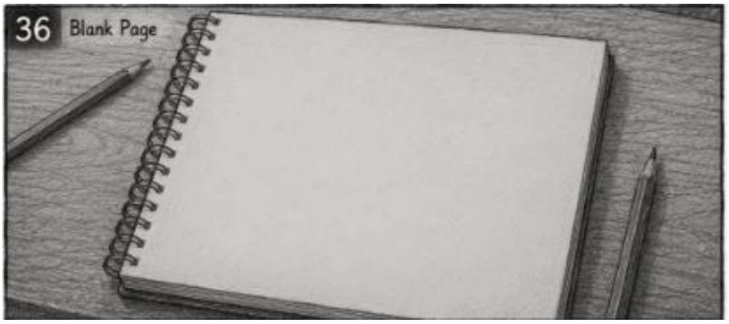
## SCENE 8

SHOT 35



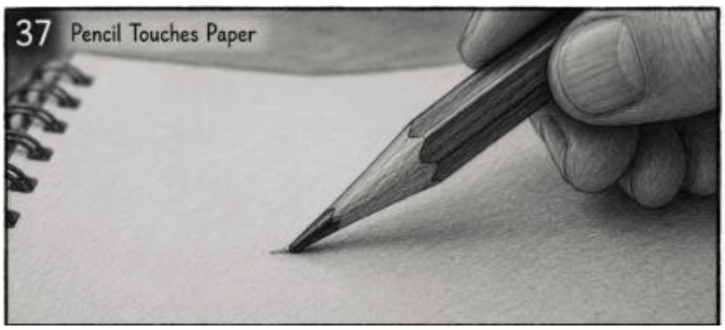

Shot Type: MEDIUM SHOT
Action: Trainer placing sketchbook on desk.
SFX: Calm dialogue.

SHOT 36




Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Empty sketchbook page.
SFX: Silence begins.

SHOT 37




Shot Type: INSERT
Action: Pencil touches paper.
SFX: Sound fades out.

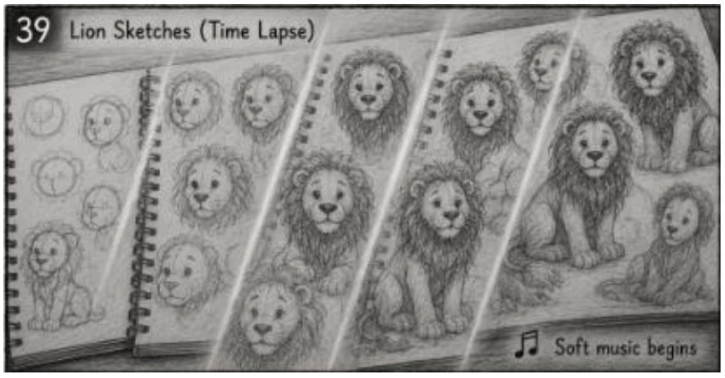
SHOT 38




Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Penny focused while drawing.
SFX: Full silence.
Storyboard Focus: First inner peace moment.

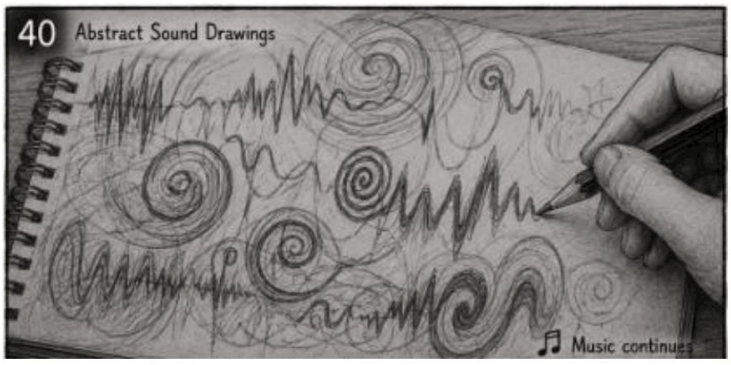
SCENE 9

SHOT 39




Shot Type: TIME LAPSE
Action: Lion drawings filling pages.
SFX: Soft music begins.

SHOT 40




Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Distorted sound-wave art.
SFX: Music continues.

SHOT 41




Shot Type: NIGHT SHOT
Action: Penny drawing late at home.
SFX: Quiet ambience.

SHOT 42




Shot Type: INSERT
Action: Quickly closing sketchbook.
SFX: Subtle tension.

SHOT 43




Shot Type: MEDIUM SHOT
Action: Trainer enters quietly.
SFX: Room tone.

SHOT 44




Shot Type: INSERT
Action: Sketchbook pages reveal emotional artwork.
SFX: Music stops.

SHOT 45




Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Trainer emotionally affected.
SFX: Silence.

SHOT 46




Shot Type: MEDIUM SHOT
Action: Book shuts abruptly.
SFX: Sharp sound cut

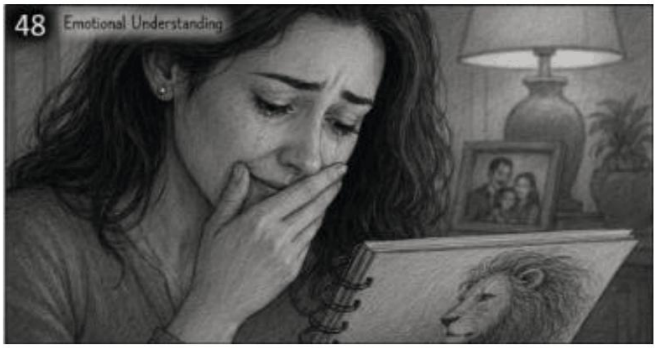
SCENE 11

SHOT 47




Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Mother looking through drawings.
SFX: Soft emotional tone.

SHOT 48




Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Mother tearing up.
SFX: Music swells lightly.

SHOT 49




Shot Type: WIDE SHOT
Action: Penny silently watches from a distance.
SFX: Quiet ambience.

## SCENE 12

SHOT 50




Shot Type: MEDIUM SHOT
Action: Penny faces mirror.
SFX: Low hum.

SHOT 51




Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Reflection subtly shifts.
SFX: Audio warping.

SHOT 52




Shot Type: POV SHOT
Action: Lion-costumed Penny in mirror.
SFX: Silence.
Storyboard Focus: Symbolic self-image.

SHOT 53




Shot Type: REVERSE SHOT
Action: Real Penny contrasted with lion reflection.
SFX: Breathing slows.

SHOT 54




Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Calm eye contact with reflection.
SFX: Calm tone begins.

SCENE 13

SHOT 55




Shot Type: TIME LAPSE
Action: Digital art progressing.
SFX: Music builds.

SHOT 56




Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Artwork of calm lion in distorted chaos.
SFX: Rhythmic score.

SHOT 57




Shot Type: INSERT
Action: Aggressive erasing and rebuilding.
SFX: Intensifying music.

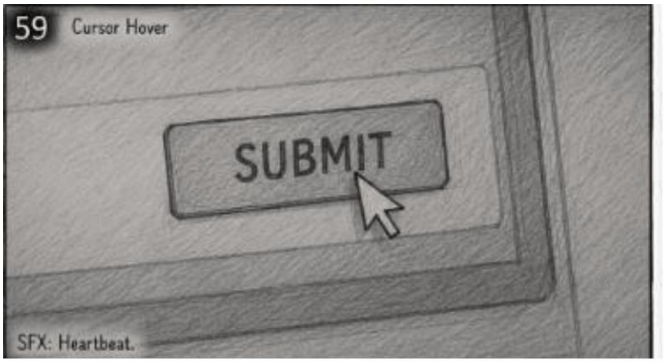
SHOT 58




Shot Type: WIDE SHOT
Action: Final artwork fully revealed.
SFX: Music resolves.

SCENE 14

SHOT 59



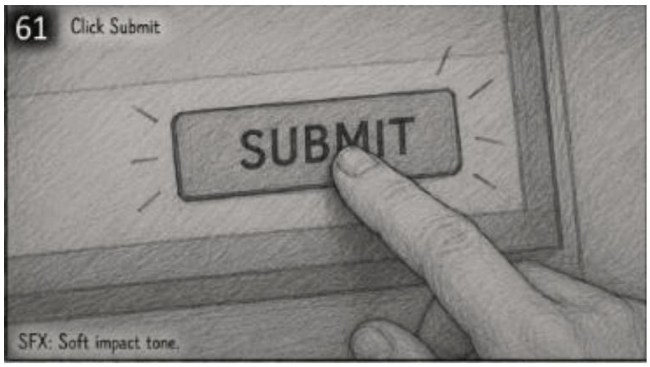

Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Cursor hovering over SUBMIT.
SFX: Heartbeat.

SHOT 60




Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Mother placing hand over Penny's.
SFX: Silence.

SHOT 61




Shot Type: INSERT
Action: Clicking submit button.
SFX: Soft impact tone.

## SCENE 15

SHOT 62




Shot Type: WIDE SHOT
Action: Crowded exhibition hall.
SFX: Crowd ambience.

SHOT 63




Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Visitors emotionally reacting.
SFX: Noise softens.

SHOT 64




Shot Type: INSERT
Action: Penny's artwork displayed.
SFX: Music begins.

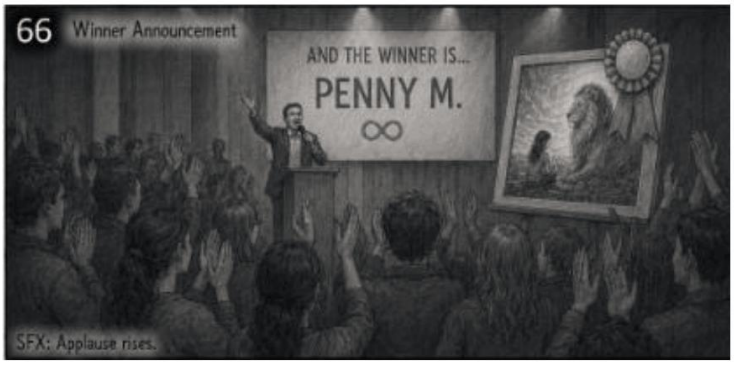
SHOT 65




Shot Type: MEDIUM SHOT
Action: Penny quietly observing people.
SFX: Controlled breathing.

SCENE 16

SHOT 66



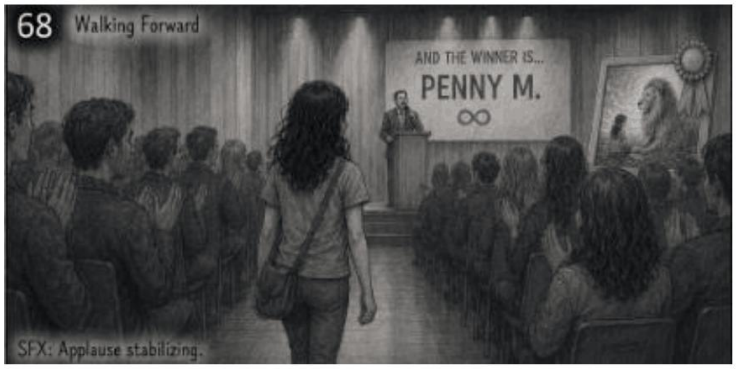

Shot Type: WIDE SHOT
Action: Host announcing winner on stage.
SFX: Applause rises.

SHOT 67




Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Penny freezes.
SFX: Distortion returns.

SHOT 68




Shot Type: TRACKING SHOT
Action: Penny slowly walking toward stage.
SFX: Applause stabilizing.

SHOT 69




Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Mother emotional in audience.
SFX: Soft music layer.

SHOT 70




Shot Type: MEDIUM SHOT
Action: Trophy handed to Penny.
SFX: Clear sound.

SHOT 71




Shot Type: CLOSE UP
Action: Lion plush in hand.
SFX: Calm ambience

SHOT 72




Shot Type: LOW ANGLE
Action: Penny raising trophy.
SFX: Music resolves.
Storyboard Focus: Empowerment.

SHOT 73




Shot Type: WIDE SHOT
Action: Penny under spotlight with calm smile.
SFX: Music blending into silence.
Storyboard Focus: Emotional resolution.

SHOT 74




Shot Type: FADE OUT
Action: Black screen.
SFX: Mother V.O begins.

## *(d) Shooting Script*

**THE VOICE OF PENNY**

**Shooting Script**

**SCENE 1 – OPENING APPLAUSE / AWARD NIGHT (COLD OPEN)**

**INT. AUDITORIUM – NIGHT**

| SHOT | TYPE | DESCRIPTION | AUDIO |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1.1 | BLACK SCREEN | No image. | Distorted applause slowly rising |
| 1.2 | EXTREME CLOSE UP | Camera flashes strobing into darkness (abstract POV). | Applause intensifies |
| 1.3 | WIDE SHOT | Auditorium stage revealed. Penny centered under spotlight, frozen. | Loud, warped applause |
| 1.4 | CLOSE UP | Penny's face—tense, overwhelmed. | Sound muffled, distorted |
| 1.5 | INSERT SHOT | Trophy shaking slightly in her hands | Sharp audio spike |
| 1.6 | CLOSE UP | Lion plush in her grip | Sound briefly drops |
| 1.7 | POV SHOT (PENNY) | Audience blurs, distortions, pressure-like motion | Audio distortion peaks |
| 1.8 | CUT TO BLACK | Hard cut | Silence |

---

**SCENE 2 – TITLE / SETUP**

| SHOT | TYPE | DESCRIPTION | AUDIO |
|---|---|---|---|
| 2.1 | TITLE CARD | "THE VOICE OF PENNY" | Silence |
| 2.2 | TITLE CARD | "THREE MONTHS EARLIER" | Ambient soft tone begins |

---

**SCENE 3 – ACADEMY ARRIVAL**

**EXT. INFINITE MINDS ACADEMY – MORNING**

| SHOT | TYPE | DESCRIPTION | AUDIO |
|---|---|---|---|
| 3.1 | ESTABLISHING SHOT | Calm exterior of academy, morning light | Birds, soft ambience |
| 3.2 | MEDIUM SHOT | Penny arrives with mother, | Low ambient noise |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | holding lion plush | |
| 3.3 | CLOSE UP | Penny avoiding eye contact | Subtle anxiety tone |
| 3.4 | MEDIUM SHOT | Ella greets them warmly | Normal dialogue ambience |

---

**SCENE 4 – HALLWAY EXPLANATION**

**INT. HALLWAY – CONTINUOUS**

| SHOT | TYPE | DESCRIPTION | AUDIO |
|---|---|---|---|
| 4.1 | TWO-SHOT | Mother speaking with Ella | Soft dialogue |
| 4.2 | CLOSE UP | Mother expressing concern | Muted environment |
| 4.3 | CLOSE UP | Ella reassuring nod | Calm tone |
| 4.4 | TRACKING SHOT | Penny being gently guided away | Footsteps echo lightly |

---

**SCENE 5 – CLASSROOM INTRODUCTION / PANIC**

**INT. CLASSROOM – DAY**

| SHOT | TYPE | DESCRIPTION | AUDIO |
|---|---|---|---|
| 5.1 | WIDE SHOT | Classroom, students seated | Normal classroom ambience |
| 5.2 | MEDIUM SHOT | Aaron introduces Penny | Clear dialogue |
| 5.3 | CLOSE UP | Students clapping politely | Applause begins |
| 5.4 | SOUND SHIFT SHOT | Visual distortion begins (handheld instability) | Applause becomes loud/harsh |
| 5.5 | POV SHOT | Students appear overwhelming, exaggerated proximity | Audio distortion increases |
| 5.6 | CLOSE UP | Penny covering ears | Breathing intensifies |
| 5.7 | HANDHELD SHOT | Sudden movement—Penny stands up | Chaotic sound peak |
| 5.8 | TRACKING SHOT | Penny runs out of classroom | Chairs scraping |

---

**SCENE 6 – HALLWAY / POSTER MOTIVATION**

**INT. HALLWAY – CONTINUOUS**

| SHOT | TYPE | DESCRIPTION | AUDIO |
|---|---|---|---|
| 6.1 | MEDIUM SHOT | Penny collapses into mother's arms | Sound dampened |
| 6.2 | CLOSE UP | Mother comforting her | Soft dialogue |
| 6.3 | INSERT SHOT | Competition poster on wall | Ambient quiet |
| 6.4 | CLOSE UP | Penny staring at poster | Subtle tonal shift |

---

**SCENE 7 – ADAPTATION MONTAGE**

| SHOT | TYPE | DESCRIPTION | AUDIO |
|---|---|---|---|
| 7.1 | WIDE SHOT | Penny sitting alone outside classroom | Ambient |
| 7.2 | CLOSE UP | Hands covering ears | Distant noise |
| 7.3 | INSERT | Lion plush in hand | Quiet |
| 7.4 | SERIES OF SHOTS | Classroom isolation / observation | Minimal sound bed |

---

**SCENE 8 – FIRST DRAWING MOMENT**

**INT. CLASSROOM – AFTERNOON**

| SHOT | TYPE | DESCRIPTION | AUDIO |
|---|---|---|---|
| 8.1 | MEDIUM SHOT | Aaron placing sketchbook on desk | Calm dialogue |
| 8.2 | CLOSE UP | Blank page | Silence begins |
| 8.3 | INSERT | Pencil touching paper | Sound fades out |
| 8.4 | CLOSE UP | Penny's focused face | Full silence |

---

**SCENE 9 – DRAWING MONTAGE**

| SHOT | TYPE | DESCRIPTION | AUDIO |
|---|---|---|---|
| 9.1 | TIME LAPSE | Lion sketches forming | Soft music begins |
| 9.2 | CLOSE UP | Abstract sound drawings | Music continues |
| 9.3 | NIGHT SHOT | Drawing at home | Quiet ambience |
| 9.4 | INSERTS | Pages flipping, hiding sketchbook | Subtle tension |

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**SCENE 10 – DISCOVERY BY AARON (TRAINER)**

**INT. CLASSROOM – EVENING**

| SHOT | TYPE | DESCRIPTION | AUDIO |
|---|---|---|---|
| 10.1 | MEDIUM SHOT | Aaron enters quietly | Room tone |
| 10.2 | INSERT | Sketchbook pages (emotional drawings) | Music stops |
| 10.3 | CLOSE UP | Aaron's reaction | Silence |
| 10.4 | MEDIUM SHOT | Penny shuts book abruptly | Sharp sound cut |

---

**SCENE 11 – HOME REALIZATION**

**INT. PENNY'S HOME – NIGHT**

| SHOT | TYPE | DESCRIPTION | AUDIO |
|---|---|---|---|
| 11.1 | CLOSE UP | Mother flipping pages | Soft emotional tone |
| 11.2 | CLOSE UP | Mother's emotional reaction | Music swells lightly |
| 11.3 | WIDE SHOT | Penny watching silently | Ambient quiet |

---

**SCENE 12 – BATHROOM MIRROR SEQUENCE**

| SHOT | TYPE | DESCRIPTION | AUDIO |
|---|---|---|---|
| 12.1 | MEDIUM SHOT | Penny facing mirror | Low hum |
| 12.2 | CLOSE UP | Reflection distortion begins | Audio warping |
| 12.3 | POV SHOT | Lion-costumed Penny in mirror | Silence |
| 12.4 | REVERSE SHOT | Real Penny vs reflection | Breathing slows |
| 12.5 | CLOSE UP | Eye contact stabilizes | Calm tone begins |

---

**SCENE 13 – FINAL ART CREATION**

| SHOT | TYPE | DESCRIPTION | AUDIO |
|---|---|---|---|
| 13.1 | TIME LAPSE | Digital painting progression | Music builds |
| 13.2 | CLOSE UP | Lion in chaos composition | Rhythmic score |
| 13.3 | INSERT | Erasing / redrawing | Intensifying music |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 13.4 | WIDE SHOT | Finished artwork revealed | Music resolves |

---

**SCENE 14 – SUBMISSION**

| SHOT | TYPE | DESCRIPTION | AUDIO |
|---|---|---|---|
| 14.1 | CLOSE UP | Cursor hovering over submit | Heartbeat sound |
| 14.2 | CLOSE UP | Mother's hand over hers | Silence |
| 14.3 | INSERT | Click "SUBMIT" | Soft impact tone |

---

**SCENE 15 – AWARD CEREMONY (CLIMAX)**

| SHOT | TYPE | DESCRIPTION | AUDIO |
|---|---|---|---|
| 16.1 | WIDE SHOT | Stage + host announcement | Applause rises |
| 16.2 | CLOSE UP | Penny freezing | Audio distortion returns |
| 16.3 | TRACKING SHOT | Penny walking forward | Applause stabilizes gradually |
| 16.4 | CLOSE UP | Mother emotional in crowd | Soft music layer |
| 16.5 | MEDIUM SHOT | Trophy handover | Clear sound now |

---

**FINAL SHOT**

| SHOT | TYPE | DESCRIPTION | AUDIO |
|---|---|---|---|
| 16.6 | CLOSE UP | Lion plush in hand | Calm ambience |
| 16.7 | LOW ANGLE | Penny raises trophy | Music resolves |
| 16.8 | VFX SHOT | Hands subtly become lion paws | Applause softens |
| 16.9 | WIDE SHOT | Penny under spotlight, calm smile | Music + silence blend |
| 16.10 | FADE OUT | Black screen | V.O begins |

---

**END**

## *(e) Shot List*

### *The Voice of Penny*

**Shot List**

🏠 **LOCATION 1 — PENNY'S HOME**

| Shot # | Framing | Angle | Description | Audio / Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 46 | CU | Front | Mother flips through sketchbook pages | Soft emotional ambience |
| 47 | CU | Front | Mother reacts emotionally | Gentle music swell |
| 48 | WS | Front | Penny watches silently | Quiet room tone |
| 49 | MS | OTS | Penny stares at competition poster | Poster visible |
| 50 | MS | Front | Penny sketches, erases, tears paper, collapses in frustration | Handheld tension |
| 51 | MS | Front | Penny faces bathroom mirror | Low ambient hum |
| 52 | CU | Front | Mirror reflection begins distorting | Audio warping |
| 53 | MS | OTS | Penny sees lion-costumed version of herself | Slow breathing |
| 54 | CU | Front | Eye contact stabilises in mirror | Calm atmosphere |
| 55 | MS | Front | Penny begins digital painting | Music gradually builds |
| 56 | CU | Front | Lion image appears amid visual chaos | Rhythmic sound design |
| 57 | CU | Front | Penny erases and redraws repeatedly | Intensifying music |
| 58 | MS | Front | Final artwork revealed | Music resolves |
| 59 | CU | Front | Cursor hovers over "SUBMIT" | Heartbeat SFX |
| 60 | CU | Front | Mother places hand over Penny's hand | Ambient silence |
| 61 | CU | Front | Penny clicks "SUBMIT" | Soft impact tone |

### 🎨 LOCATION 2 — INFINITE MINDS ACADEMY (EXTERIOR & HALLWAY)

| Shot # | Framing | Angle | Description | Audio / Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 9 | WS | Front | Exterior establishing shot of academy | Static composition |
| 10 | MS | Front | Penny arrives with Mother holding lion plush | Tracking shot |
| 11 | CU | Front | Penny avoids eye contact | Anxiety ambience |
| 12 | MS | Front | Ella warmly greets them | Natural dialogue |
| 13 | MS | OTS | Mother speaks with Ella | “She gets overwhelmed easily…” |
| 14 | CU | Front | Mother expresses concern | Muted ambience |
| 15 | MS | OTS | Ella reassures Mother | “We’ll go at her pace.” |
| 16 | MS | Front | Penny guided toward building interior | Echoing footsteps |
| 25 | MS | Front | Penny collapses into Mother’s arms | Audio dampened |
| 26 | CU | Front | Mother comforts Penny | “Penny, it’s alright.” |
| 27 | CU | Front | Competition poster on wall | Quiet ambience |
| 28 | CU | Front | Penny stares at poster | Tonal shift |

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### 🎓 LOCATION 3 — INFINITE MINDS ACADEMY (CLASSROOM)

| Shot # | Framing | Angle | Description | Audio / Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 17 | MWS | Front | Classroom with seated students | Natural ambience |
| 18 | MS | Front | Aaron introduces Penny | “Everyone, this is Penny.” |
| 19 | CU | Front | Students clap politely | Applause begins |
| 20 | MS | Front | Visual distortion begins | Handheld instability |
| 21 | MS | POV | Students become visually overwhelming | Audio distortion |
| 22 | CU | Front | Penny covers ears | Heavy breathing |
| 23 | MS | Front | Penny suddenly stands | Chaotic sound peak |
| 24 | MS | Front | Penny runs out of classroom | Tracking movement |
| 33 | MS | Front | Aaron places sketchbook on desk | “You can draw anything.” |
| 34 | CU | Front | Blank sketchbook page | Silence |
| 35 | CU | Front | Pencil touches paper | Sound fades |
| 36 | CU | Front | Penny intensely focused | Full silence |
| 37 | CU | Front | Lion sketches forming | Soft music begins |
| 38 | CU | Front | Abstract sound drawings | Music continues |
| 40 | MS | Front | Penny flips pages, hides sketchbook | Subtle handheld tension |
| 41 | MS | Front | Aaron quietly enters | Room tone |
| 42 | CU | Front | Emotional drawings revealed | Music cuts |
| 43 | CU | Front | Aaron reacts emotionally | Silence |
| 44 | MS | Front | Aaron encourages Penny | “You don’t have to hide this.” |
| 45 | MS | Front | Penny shuts sketchbook abruptly | Sharp sound cut |

### 🎭 LOCATION 4 — AUDITORIUM / STAGE

| Shot # | Framing | Angle | Description | Audio / Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Montage | Various | Black screen with distorted applause | Rising applause |
| 2 | ECU | POV | Camera flashes burst through darkness | Handheld flashes |
| 3 | WS | Front | Penny frozen under spotlight | Loud warped applause |
| 4 | CU | Front | Penny overwhelmed on stage | Distorted ambience |
| 5 | CU | Front | Trophy shaking in Penny's hands | Sharp audio spike |
| 6 | CU | Front | Lion plush tightly clutched | Audio briefly drops |
| 7 | MWS | POV | Audience visually distorted | Distortion peaks |
| 8 | Montage | Various | Cut to black | Silence |
| 67 | WS | Front | Host announces winner | "The winner is… Penny." |
| 68 | CU | Front | Penny freezes | Distortion returns |
| 69 | MS | Front | Penny walks toward stage | Applause stabilises |
| 70 | CU | Front | Mother watches emotionally | Soft music |
| 71 | MS | Front | Penny accepts trophy | Audience applause |
| 72 | CU | Front | Lion plush in hand | Calm ambience |
| 73 | MS | Low Angle | Penny raises trophy | Musical resolution |
| 74 | Montage | POV | Hands subtly transform into lion paws | Applause softens |
| 75 | WS | Front | Penny smiles beneath spotlight | Music blends with silence |
| 76 | Montage | Various | Fade to black | Mother V.O. |

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🏫 **LOCATION 5 — IMA EXTERIOR & HALLWAY (PENNY ONLY)**

**Time Block: 3:00 PM – 6:00 PM**

**Scenes Covered: Isolation / observation montage / emotional aftermath**

| Shot # | Framing | Angle | Description | Audio / Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 29 | WS | Front | Penny sits alone outside classroom | Ambient hallway tone |
| 30 | CU | Front | Penny covers ears | Distant classroom noise |
| 31 | CU | Front | Lion plush in Penny's hands | Quiet emotional emphasis |
| 32 | Montage | Various | Isolation montage through classroom window/doorway | Minimal sound design |

## *(f) Budget Management*

| Item No. | Item | Cost | Paied By | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Penny | 339.95 | Wu | | |
| 2 | Mother | 240 | Wu | | |
| 3 | Teacher (IMA) | | | | |
| 4 | Trainer (IMA) | | | | |
| 5 | Mr. Lion (costume) | 47.49 | Wu | | |
| 6 | Crayons | 18.4 | Wu | | |
| 7 | Colour Pencils | 9.31 | Wu | | |
| 8 | Sketchbook | 12.69 | Wu | | |
| 9 | Mr. DIY props | 45.4 | Ren | | |
| 10 | House | 308.38 | Ren | | |
| 11 | Lion plush | 27.22 | Wu | | |
| 12 | Logistics (for Teacher) | 15 | Wu | | |
| 13 | Dinner 22nd May | 156.1 | Ren | | |
| 14 | Lunch 22nd May | 76.5 | Wu | | |
| 15 | Printing | 42.5 | Ren | | |
| 16 | Rental Equipmetns (tripod & lighting | 180 | Ren | | |
| 17 | Trophy | 70 | Arun | | |
| 18 | Grab | 20 | Arun | | |
| 19 | Breakfast 22nd May | 14 | Arun | Budegt: | 1050 RM |
| 20 | Parking | 15 | Ren | Total Cost: | 1713.64 RM |
| 21 | Bolt to Trion | 22 | Ren | Cost/person | 571.2133 RM |
| 22 | Breakfast DayII | 12 | Ren | | |
| 23 | Water fee for crew | 21.7 | Ren | Wu | 786.56 RM |
| 24 | Breakfast 22nd May | 12 | Ren | Ren | 823.08 RM |
| 25 | Bolt to LRT | 8 | Ren | Arun | 104 RM |

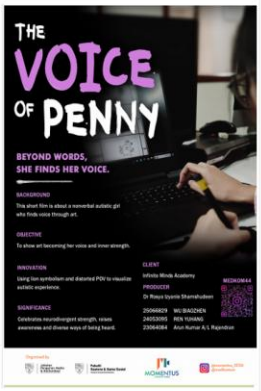
## Appendix D: Production Documents

### *(g) Call Sheet*

**The project**

**The Voice of Penny**

The Voice of Penny follows Penny, a nonverbal autistic teenager overwhelmed by the world around her. Through art, she slowly expresses emotions she cannot speak aloud. Despite fear and anxiety, Penny gains courage to share her artwork publicly and finally discovers her own voice through creativity and emotional connection.




**Talent / Crew**

**WU BIAOZHEN**
**(Director, Scriptwriter)**

Tel.: 60179587419

Email: 25066829@siswa.um.edu.my

**ARUN KUMAR RAJENDRAN**
**(Director of Photography)**

Tel.:1151199462

Email: 23064084@siwa.um.edu.my

**REN YUHANG**
**(Cameraman)**

Tel.: 60173162593

Email: 24053095@siswa.um.edu.my

**Nur Farhani Samantha Woodford**
**(Actress)**

**YONG YUEN YEE**
**(Actress)**

**Aaron Yap (Actor)**

**HU HUIWEN (Actress)**

**Locations**




**Infinite Minds Academy**

B-3-5, 3 Two Square, 2, Jalan 19/1, Section 19, 46300 Petaling Jaya, Selangor




**SFM DREAM HOUSE- Trion KL**

B-3-5, 3 Two Square, 2, Jalan 19/1, Section 19, 46300 Petaling Jaya, Selangor

**Universiti Malaya** - Auditorium

**Schedule**

**Day 1: Thursday 21st May**

**(Cast: Nur Farhani Samantha Woodford, Aaron Yap)**

**2:00PM - 3:00 PM**

Cast Arrival & Rehearsal

**3:00PM - 6:00 PM**

IMA Shooting

**6:00PM - 7:00 PM**

Company Move and Dinner

**7:00PM - 9:30 PM**

Apartment shoot block (Penny only)

**9:30 PM Wrap up**

**Day 2: Friday 22nd May**

**(Cast: Nur Farhani Samantha Woodford, YONG YUEN YEE, HU HUIWEN)**

**8:00AM - 9:00 AM**

Cast Call & Set up

**9:00AM - 12:00 PM**

Apartment shoot block (With Mother)

**12:00PM - 1:00 PM**

Lunch break

**1:00PM - 3:00 PM**

Company Move to IMA

**3:00PM - 6:00 PM**

IMA Hallway shoot block (With Mother)

**6:00PM - 7:30 PM**

Move to UM and Dinner

**7:30PM - 9:30 PM**

UM Auditorium shoot block

**9:30 PM Wrap up**

## *(h) Permission Letter: Infinite Minds Academy*

UNIVERSITI MALAYA

**19 May 2026**

**Aaron Yap**
Infinite Minds Academy
B-3-5, 3 Two Square, 2, Jalan 19/1, Section 19
46300 Petaling Jaya, Selangor

**Through**

**Assoc. Professor Dr. Md Azalanshah Md Syed**
Head

Department of Media and Communication Studies
Faculty of Arts and Social Sciences

**Dr. Rosya Izyanie Shamshudeen**
Supervisor
Universiti Malaya

**REQUEST FOR PERMISSION TO CONDUCT FILMING AT INFINITE MINDS ACADEMY**

Dear Mr. Aaron Yap,
I am **Wu Biaozhen**, a student of the Master of Media Studies programme, Faculty of Arts and Social Sciences, Universiti Malaya. I am currently undertaking AQA7019 Creative Media Project, which requires the production of a short film for the MOMENTUS 2026 graduate exhibition.

I would like to respectfully request your permission to conduct production shooting at **Infinite Minds Academy** for my creative media project. The details of the proposed shooting are as follows:

Project title: *The Voice of Penny*
Project genre: Short film
Location: Infinite Minds Academy – classrooms, hallways, and office
Date(s) of shooting: Thursday, 21st May 2026 and Friday, 22nd May 2026
Time: 3:00 PM – 6:00 PM
Name of client/company/organisation: Infinite Minds Academy
Name of supervisor: Dr. Rosya Izyanie Shamshudeen

The purpose of this location shooting is to capture key classroom and hallway scenes that form the core of our short film. These scenes depict Penny's experiences at the academy and are essential to

the narrative. The production is strictly for academic purposes and will be screened only at the MOMENTUS exhibition within Universiti Malaya.

I understand that safety, discipline, and the good name of Universiti Malaya must be prioritised at all times. I hereby confirm that I will take full responsibility for my conduct and that of my crew during the shooting. We will comply with all instructions from your team, respect the academy's property and students, and ensure that the location is left in its original condition after filming.

I sincerely hope that you will kindly grant us permission to shoot at Infinite Minds Academy. Your support and collaboration have been invaluable, and we greatly appreciate the opportunity to work with you.

Thank you for your consideration.

Yours sincerely,



.....

**Wu Biaozhen**
Matric No.: 25066829
Master of Media Studies
Department of Media and Communication Studies

## *(i) Permission Letter: Trion Apartment*

UNIVERSITI MALAYA

**19 May 2026**

**The Management / Owner**
SFM DREAM HOUSE – Trion KL
Jalan Dua, Trion, Chan Sow Lin
55200 Kuala Lumpur
Wilayah Persekutuan Kuala Lumpur
Malaysia

**Through**

Assoc. Professor Dr. Md Azalanshah Md Syed
Head

Department of Media and Communication Studies

Dr. Rosya Izyanie Shamshudeen
Supervisor

**REQUEST FOR PERMISSION TO CONDUCT FILMING AT SFM DREAM HOUSE – TRION KL FOR AQA7019 CREATIVE MEDIA PROJECT**

Dear Management / Owner,

I am **Wu Biaozhen** (Matric No.: 25066829), a student of the Master of Media Studies programme, Faculty of Arts and Social Sciences, Universiti Malaya. I am currently undertaking AQA7019 Creative Media Project, which requires the production of a short film for the MOMENTUS graduate exhibition.

I would like to respectfully request your permission to use **SFM DREAM HOUSE – Trion KL** as a filming location for my creative media project. The details of the proposed shooting are as follows:

Project title: *The Voice of Penny*
Project genre: Short film
Location: SFM DREAM HOUSE – Trion KL, Jalan Dua, Trion, Chan Sow Lin, 55200 Kuala Lumpur
Date(s) of shooting: Thursday, 21st May 2026 and Friday, 22nd May 2026
Time: Morning and Evening – to be confirmed upon your approval
Name of client/company/organisation: Infinite Minds Academy
Name of supervisor: Dr. Rosya Izyanie Shamshudeen

The purpose of this location shooting is to capture **interior home scenes** for our short film, including bedroom, living room, kitchen, and bathroom sequences. These scenes are essential to the narrative, as they depict Penny's private space where her artistic journey unfolds. The production is strictly for academic purposes and will be screened only at the MOMENTUS exhibition within Universiti Malaya.

I understand that safety, discipline, and the good name of Universiti Malaya must be prioritised at all times during the production process.

I hereby confirm that I will take full responsibility for my conduct and that of my crew throughout the shooting. I will ensure that the apartment is kept clean, that no permanent modifications are made to the property, and that the space is left in its original condition upon completion. I will also comply with all instructions from your management or owner, including any restrictions on noise, movement, or usage of facilities.

I sincerely hope that you will kindly consider and approve this application. Your support would greatly contribute to the success of this academic project.

Thank you very much for your kind consideration.



.....

**Wu Biaozhen**
Matric No.: 25066829
Master of Media Studies
Department of Media and Communication Studies

**JABATAN PENGAJIAN MEDIA DAN KOMUNIKASI**
Fakulti Sastera dan Sains Sosial, Universiti Malaya, 50603 Kuala Lumpur, MALAYSIA

Tel: (603) 7967 5419 / 5423 • E-mel: fass_media@um.edu.my

## *(j) Permission Letter: UM Auditorium*

UNIVERSITI MALAYA

**19 May 2026**

Associate Professor Dr. Yanti Idaya Aspura Mohd Khalid
Dean
Faculty of Arts and Social Sciences

**Through**

Assoc. Professor Dr. Md Azalanshah Md Syed
Head

Department of Media and Communication Studies

Dr. Rosya Izyanie Shamshudeen
Supervisor

**REQUEST FOR PERMISSION TO USE AUDITORIUM FOR SHORT FILM SHOOTING FOR AQA7019 CREATIVE MEDIA PROJECT**

Dear Associate Professor Dr. Yanti Idaya Aspura,

I am **Wu Biaozhen** (Matric No.: 25066829), a student of the Master of Media Studies programme, Faculty of Arts and Social Sciences, Universiti Malaya. I am currently undertaking AQA7019 Creative Media Project, which requires the production of a short film for the MOMENTUS graduate exhibition.

I would like to respectfully request permission to use the **auditorium at the Department of Media and Communication Studies** as a filming location for my project. The details are as follows:

Project title: *The Voice of Penny*
Project genre: Short film
Location: Auditorium, Department of Media and Communication Studies, Faculty of Arts and Social Sciences, Universiti Malaya
Date(s) of shooting: Friday, 22nd May 2026
Time: 6:00 PM - 9:00 PM
Name of client/company/organisation: Infinite Minds Academy
Name of supervisor: Dr. Rosya Izyanie Shamshudeen

The purpose is to film the award ceremony climax scene for my short film. The auditorium provides the necessary formal setting required for this scene. The production is strictly for academic purposes and will be screened only at the MOMENTUS exhibition within the university.

I hereby confirm that I will take full responsibility for my conduct and that of my crew. We will ensure the auditorium is left in its original condition and will comply with all university safety and operational regulations.

I sincerely hope that the faculty will consider and approve this application.

Thank you.

Yours sincerely,



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**Wu Biaozhen**
Matric No.: 25066829
Master of Media Studies
Department of Media and Communication Studies